

Henry F. Matola — Service Timeline

Private First Class, D Company, 47th Infantry Regiment (“The Raiders”), 9th Infantry Division

Edition 1 • July 2026

Born: April 20, 1919, Youngstown, Ohio **Died:** July 29, 2007 (age 88) **Parents:** Anthony R. and Mildred Matola, 733 Crandall Ave., Youngstown (Mahoning County), Ohio **Education:** Rayen School, Youngstown, Ohio **Serial/Service Number:** 15013984 (George Kysilka: 15013985 — consecutive, confirmed by Oct 1940 roster) **George Kysilka (Kysilka):** Born April 7, 1923, Cleveland, Ohio (Cuyahoga County), to Tomas Kysilka and Mary Vyskocli. Died November 5, 1991, Twinsburg, Ohio. Residence: Cuyahoga, Ohio. Single, grammar school education. Enlisted Oct 13, 1940, Fort Hayes, Columbus, Ohio. Regular Army, Infantry. Height 73”, Weight 164 lbs. SN 15013985. Photo: B2-59 (formal Class A portrait, Fort Bragg). **Enlisted:** October 13, 1940, Fort Hayes, Columbus, Ohio. Basic training: Fort Bragg, NC (Nov 1940) **Wounded:** June 16, 1944 — Seriously wounded in action (SWA) by artillery shell fragments across the right side — jaw and chest (Co. D morning report), penetrating wound to the right shoulder (305th Station Hospital A&D report), neck (SGO Hospital Admission Card). Treated at the **192nd General Hospital** operating **US Army Hospital Plant 4150** at the **15th Hospital Center, Cirencester Park, Gloucestershire, England** (Jun 21–Jul 13) — admitted via an Evacuation Hospital in Normandy (1 day, per SGO Hospital Admission Card) and the **305th Station Hospital** (Jun 19). 29 non-effective days. Released from hospital **Jul 13, 1944**. *(See revised return-to-unit narrative below — released to a replacement depot in England, then through a months-long replacement-depot chain in France before being returned to the 47th Infantry on Oct 29, 1944, per the morning-report record [S18]. The earlier statement that he returned to D Company in July is corrected.)* **Discharged:** June 24, 1945, Honorable Discharge, Fort Dix, New Jersey **Awards (confirmed — physical medals in family possession):** Purple Heart; Bronze Star Medal; American Defense Service Medal; American Campaign Medal; European-African-Middle Eastern Campaign Medal with 1 silver and 1 bronze service star (6 campaigns); World War II Victory Medal; Good Conduct Medal; Combat Infantryman Badge (1st Award); Honorable Service Lapel Button (“Ruptured Duck”) **Note:** Henry told his family that of the 127 men in D Company who landed in North Africa, only 7 made it to the war’s end. This figure comes from family history (S7)

and has not been independently verified against military records — no embarkation roster or VE Day roster for D Company has been located **Original service record destroyed in the 1973 NPRC fire**. This file is a mini reconstruction from alternate sources.

Compiled following the **Genealogical Proof Standard (GPS)** methodology (GRA v8.5.1c, Steve Little). Sources are classified using the Three-Layer Model: Source type (Original/Derivative/Author), Information type (Primary/Secondary/Indeterminate), and Evidence type (Direct/Indirect/Negative). Confidence levels: **Proved** (2+ independent original sources with primary information, no conflicts), **Probable** (strong evidence, minor gaps), **Possible** (single source or indirect evidence), **Not Proved** (insufficient evidence).

Note on NARA filing: The prefix “309-INF(47)” in NARA record labels is a decimal classification number, not a unit designation. “309” is the NARA file series; “(47)” identifies the 47th Infantry Regiment. The 60th Infantry Regiment of the same division is filed as “309-INF(60).”

Stateside — Fort Bragg, NC (1940–1942)

Henry enlisted October 1940 at Fort Hayes, Columbus, Ohio and reported to Fort Bragg, NC for basic training in November 1940. The 47th Infantry Regiment was reactivated August 1, 1940 at Fort Bragg and organized August 10, 1940. Its original personnel was composed of cadres from the 9th Infantry Regiment and the 23rd Infantry Regiment, Fort Sam Houston, Texas — each cadre consisting of 23 sergeants, 26 corporals, 45 privates first class, and 105 privates. D Company unit histories begin in January 1943, and the earliest H Company narrative previously available began in September 1942. The 2026 NARA trip, however, recovered an earlier **Company H duty journal (309-INF(47) 9-o.1)** running from the regiment’s activation through February 1941. It records the founding cadre “transferred from Inf. Unasgd., Fort Sam Houston, Texas, August 13, 1940 and assigned to Company H,” then documents the company forming up week by week — the fall 1940 recruit intake and, on **31 January 1941, the arrival of the first Selective Service draftees**. As the sister 2nd-Battalion heavy-weapons company, H Company’s journal closely mirrors the process D Company went through in the very same weeks, when Henry joined D Company on 21 October 1940 (NARA RG 407, 309-INF(47) 9-o.1, Box 6507; see [data/nara/Box6507/](#)). OMPF monthly rosters (S12, pages 14–61) confirm Henry’s continuous presence in D Company from October 1940 through August 1942 — every monthly roster in this period lists him as present for duty. The September and October 1941 rosters are filed from “Maneuver Area, Chester, S.C.,” confirming D Company’s participation in the Carolina Maneuvers.

Daily routine (Service Calls): The 47th Infantry's own General Orders from this period — NARA RG 407, file 309-INF(47)-1.13, Box 6494 (General Orders No. 2, Sept 1, 1940; No. 4, Sept 30, 1940; revised repeatedly through Feb 1942) — preserve the exact daily schedule Henry lived by. The weekday routine ran by the bugle: Reveille (first call) 6:30 AM, Mess 7:15 AM, Sick Call 7:30 AM, Drill 7:50–11:30 AM, dinner Mess at noon, afternoon Drill 12:50–4:00 PM, Guard Mount 4:15 PM, Retreat 5:00 PM (flag lowered), supper 5:05 PM, Tattoo 9:00 PM, Call to Quarters 10:45 PM, Taps 11:00 PM. Sundays shifted Reveille to 7:00 AM with Church Call at 10:00 AM. Guard duty was constant — a company could stand guard a full week continuously before relief — and a completed tour as orderly or on guard earned the man a 24-hour pass. The schedule was re-issued repeatedly (Oct 1940, May 1941, Dec 1941, Jan–Feb 1942) as the regiment expanded toward war; by October 1942 the post stood up a consolidated Reception Center and Induction Station. As a private in D Company throughout this period, Henry answered every one of these calls. Source: `data/nara/Box6494/309-INF(47)-1.13_1941-1942-G0.md` (Apple-OCR digest of the 2026 NARA captures, signed *by order of Lt. Col. Patch*, regimental commander).

Regimental narrative (the “Raiders” yearbook): The printed regimental history *RAIDERS* (NARA 309-INF(47)-0.1, Box 6490; see `data/nara/Box6490/`) supplies the connective narrative for this whole period — the years before any unit journal in our collection begins. It records the command lineage of Henry's regiment: Capt. Earl L. Ringler (to 16 Aug 1940), then Maj. Forrest E. Ambrose, then Lt. Col. **Alexander M. Patch** (2 Sept 1940 – 7 Aug 1941, later commander of the Seventh Army). Under Patch the regiment moved from the Tent City pyramidal-tent camp into permanent barracks on **3 January 1941**. Training was relentless — including a **27-mile road march in July 1941** heat that the booklet calls “a highlight of Fort Bragg days.” For the **Carolina Maneuvers**, Col. Edwin H. Randle took command (10 Aug 1941), then Col. Samuel A. Gibson (27 Aug); the 47th reached its base camp at **Rock Hill, S.C.** on 26 Sept 1941 (later moved to Lancaster, S.C.) for the Fourth Corps / First Army exercise against the 8th and 26th Divisions. (The OMPF rosters file Henry from the nearby “Chester, S.C.” maneuver area in Sept–Oct 1941; Rock Hill, Lancaster, and Chester are adjacent towns in the same maneuver region.) After Pearl Harbor — which “halt[ed] further discharges of 28-year-olds” who had been slated for release on 8 Dec 1941 — the regiment's **first war mission was the defense of vital points in North Carolina** (manufacturing plants, bridges, waterworks, dams), with elements scattered across the state from mid-December into January. **Amphibious training** then dominated 1942: introduced in January with mock-ups and landings at **McFayden's Pond**; an Army Day amphibious demonstration on **6 April 1942**; the first real exercise from **21 June 1942** (by train to Norfolk, then naval transport to Solomon's Island in Chesapeake Bay) ending **24 July**; and further landings **6–15 August 1942** at the Marine base, New River, N.C. The booklet then fixes

the embarkation sequence: orders to the port of embarkation came **7 October 1942**; an advance party of Cos. “K” and “L” left for Hampton Roads on **12 Oct**; the **1st Battalion (Henry’s) embarked 17 Oct**; and the regiment was fully aboard and sailed on **19 Oct 1942**.

Personal photographs: 95 photos survive from the Fort Bragg period (photos/catalog.json). Batch 1 (30 photos) shows the initial pyramid tent camp; Batch 2 (64 photos + 1 colorized) shows the permanent barracks area, motor pool, and athletic field. Photo B2-47 shows the 9th Infantry Division Octofoil insignia and a company guidon painted on a building facade, providing direct original-source evidence confirming the division assignment. Photo B2-10 shows regimental truck motor pool with bumper markings including “47” (47th Infantry). Equipment photographed includes M1917A1 .30 cal water-cooled machine guns (B2-07/08 — consistent with D Company’s role as 1st Battalion heavy weapons company), M3 half-tracks (B2-11/12), Harley-Davidson WLA motorcycles (B2-09/15), and M1903 Springfield rifles (B2-17/24/25/27/34/58). Winter photos (B2-30 through B2-32, B2-37, B2-39, B2-46, B2-48) show heavy snow covering the motor pool. Source classification: Original source, Primary information (photographer was present), Direct evidence for location/equipment/companions; Indirect evidence for dates.

Date	Location	Event	Source
Aug 1, 1940	Fort Bragg, NC (35.14°N, 79.01°W)	47th Infantry Regiment reactivated	Henry Military Service.docx
Oct 13, 1940	Fort Hayes, Columbus, OH (39.96°N, 82.99°W)	Henry enlisted. SN 15013984. George Kysilka (b. Apr 7, 1923, Cleveland, OH; resident of Cuyahoga County) enlisted same day, SN 15013985. Both initially assigned to Hq and MP Co, 9th Division	OMPF Certification of Military Service / Oct 1940 Roster / George Kysilka Army Enlistment Record
Oct 21, 1940	Fort Bragg, NC	Henry and George transferred to D Company, 47th Infantry from Hq and MP Co, 9th Div	Oct 1940 Roster
Oct 31, 1940	Fort Bragg, NC	First monthly roster: Henry listed as Private, D Company, 47th Infantry. Company commanded by Capt. Madison C. Schepps. 1st Sgt: William M. Gatewood	OMPF Oct 1940 Roster
Nov 1940	Fort Bragg, NC	Basic training began. Henry’s personal photographs (Batch 1, B1-01 through B1-30) document life in the pyramid tent camp — canvas tents pitched in sandy pine forests, cots, field stoves, woodpile details. Henry confirmed in B1-01 (Class A uniform, garrison cap). Training photographs show the tools of basic infantry training in this period	OMPF Questionnaire / Henry Research NARA.docx / Photos B1 series (S16)

Date	Location	Event	Source
Nov 30, 1940	Fort Bragg, NC	Monthly roster: Henry listed as Private, D Company. George Kysilka also present	OMPF Nov 1940 Roster (S12, p.17–18)
Dec 31, 1940	Fort Bragg, NC	Monthly roster: Henry listed as Private, D Company	OMPF Dec 1940 Roster (S12, p.19–20)
Jan 31, 1941	Fort Bragg, NC	Monthly roster: Henry listed, D Company. 1st Sgt. Gatewood still commanding NCO	OMPF Jan 1941 Roster (S12, p.21–22)
Feb 28, 1941	Fort Bragg, NC	Henry promoted from Private to Private First Class (PFC). The Jan 31, 1941 roster still lists him as PVT; the Feb 28, 1941 roster lists him as PFC, with a status-code date of 13 Feb 1941 — the same date appears against several other D Company men promoted the same day (Keener, Keller, Madden, Mack, Nichols), consistent with a batch promotion after completing initial training, roughly 4 months after enlistment (Oct 13, 1940). No promotion order is cited anywhere in the file — checked the roster form itself (WD AGO Form 305, a personnel-accounting card that records the change via a status code + date, not an order number) and full-text-searched all 201 pages for “Special Order”/”S.O. No.” near this date: no hits. This differs from the CIB and Drivers & Mechanics Badge, which were announced by specific numbered General Orders (Box 6495) — routine PFC promotions for privates in this peacetime-forming unit were likely authorized under the company commander’s blanket promotion authority rather than a numbered order, or the order simply isn’t part of this reconstruction	OMPF Feb 1941 Roster (S12, p.23–24), verified 2026-07-06 by direct page image review (rosters Oct 1940–Feb 1941 checked page-by-page)
Mar 31, 1941	Fort Bragg, NC	Monthly roster: Henry listed, D Company	OMPF Mar 1941 Roster (S12, p.25–26)
Jan 3, 1941	Fort Bragg, NC	Regiment moved from the Tent City pyramidal-tent camp into permanent two-story wooden barracks (date per the <i>RAIDERS</i> regimental history). Henry’s photos shift from tent-camp subjects (Batch 1) to barracks area, company street, and motor pool (Batch 2), corroborating the transition	RAIDERS regtl history (S20) / Photos B1 vs B2 series (S16)
Jul 31, 1941	Fort Bragg, NC	Monthly roster: Henry listed, D Company	OMPF Jul 1941 Roster (S12, p.32–33)

Date	Location	Event	Source
1941	Fort Bragg, NC	D Company trained with M1917A1 .30 cal water-cooled machine guns (B2-07/08), M3 half-tracks (B2-11/12), Harley-Davidson WLA motorcycles (B2-09/15), and M1903 Springfield rifles (B2-17/24/25/27/34/58). Equipment consistent with D Company's role as 1st Battalion heavy weapons company. Photo B2-47 shows 9th Infantry Division Octofoil insignia and company guidon painted on barracks building. Photo B2-10 shows regimental truck motor pool with "47" bumper markings	Photos B2 series (S16)
Sep 30, 1941	Maneuver Area, Chester, SC (34.70°N, 81.18°W)	Carolina Maneuvers. Monthly roster filed from "Maneuver Area, Chester, S.C." — confirms D Company participated in the GHQ-directed Carolina Maneuvers (the largest peacetime military exercise in U.S. history, involving ~400,000 troops). Henry present on roster	OMPF Sep 1941 Roster (S12, p.36–37) / Henry Military Service.docx (S7)
Oct 1941	Maneuver Area, Chester, SC	Carolina Maneuvers continued. October roster also filed from Chester, SC maneuver area	OMPF Oct 1941 Roster (S12, p.38–39) / Henry Military Service.docx (S7)
Nov 30, 1941	Fort Bragg, NC	Monthly roster: Henry listed, D Company. Unit returned to Fort Bragg from Carolina Maneuvers	OMPF Nov 1941 Roster (S12, p.40–41)
Dec 7, 1941	Fort Bragg, NC	Japanese attack on Pearl Harbor. United States enters World War II. Henry had been in the Army for 14 months	Historical record
Dec 31, 1941	Fort Bragg, NC	Monthly roster: Henry listed, D Company	OMPF Dec 1941 Roster (S12, p.42–43)
Winter 1941–1942	Fort Bragg, NC	Heavy snowfall documented in personal photographs — motor pool vehicles (half-tracks, trucks, jeeps) buried under snow drifts; soldiers in long overcoats. Fort Bragg rarely receives heavy snow; the men photographed it extensively (7 winter photos survive). Confidence: Possible — photos are Batch 2 (barracks era); could be winter 1940–41, but permanent barracks and motor pool equipment suggest 1941–42	Photos B2-30/31/32/37/39/46/48 (S16)
Jan 31, 1942	Fort Bragg, NC	Monthly roster: Henry listed, D Company	OMPF Jan 1942 Roster (S12, p.44–45)

Date	Location	Event	Source
Feb 28, 1942	Fort Bragg, NC	Monthly roster: Henry listed, D Company	OMPF Feb 1942 Roster (S12, p.46–47)
Mar 31, 1942	Fort Bragg, NC	Monthly roster: Henry listed, D Company	OMPF Mar 1942 Roster (S12, p.48–49)
Apr 30, 1942	Fort Bragg, NC	Monthly roster: Henry listed, D Company	OMPF Apr 1942 Roster (S12, p.50–51)
May 31, 1942	Fort Bragg, NC	Monthly roster: Henry listed, D Company	OMPF May 1942 Roster (S12, p.52–53)
Jun 30, 1942	Fort Bragg, NC	Monthly roster: Henry listed, D Company	OMPF Jun 1942 Roster (S12, p.54–55)
Jul 31, 1942	Fort Bragg, NC	Monthly roster: Henry listed, D Company	OMPF Jul 1942 Roster (S12, p.56–57)
Aug 31, 1942	Fort Bragg, NC	Monthly roster: Henry listed, D Company. George Kysilka also confirmed present. Note: Henry Military Service.docx (S7) claims “Left Ft. Bragg” on Aug 1 — this roster proves the unit was still at Fort Bragg at end of August	OMPF Aug 1942 Roster (S12, p.58–59)
Aug 1, 1942	Fort Bragg, NC	Per Henry Military Service.docx: “Left Ft. Bragg.” Note: H Company records show the unit still at Fort Bragg through Oct 14, 1942, and the Aug 31 monthly roster (S12) confirms the unit present at Fort Bragg. This date may refer to a temporary movement or may be inaccurate (S7 is an authored source with known date conflicts)	Henry Military Service.docx
Sep 26, 1942	Fort Bragg, NC	Moved from barracks to staging area on Chicken Road; pitched camp	H Co.
Sep 26 – Oct 12, 1942	Fort Bragg, NC	Vigorous training and physical conditioning in preparation for departure. Replacements arriving from Camp Wheeler, GA	H Co.
Oct 13, 1942	Fort Bragg, NC	Final physical examinations; equipment checked	H Co.

Date	Location	Event	Source
Oct 14, 1942	Fort Bragg, NC	Left bivouac at 2100 by motor convoy; boarded train at midnight	H Co.

Voyage to North Africa (Oct–Nov 1942)

Date	Location	Event	Source
Oct 15, 1942	Newport News, VA (36.98°N, 76.43°W)	Arrived by rail; boarded USS Dorothea L. Dix at 1500	H Co.
Oct 16, 1942	Newport News, VA	Sailed at 1430	H Co.
Oct 18–19, 1942	Chesapeake Bay	Practice landing operations	H Co.
Oct 23, 1942	Chesapeake Bay	Sailed for Safi, French Morocco; troops notified of destination	H Co.
Oct 24 – Nov 7, 1942	At sea	Training program: calisthenics, landing practice, map studies. Multiple submarine alerts. Two aircraft carriers join convoy. Rough seas	H Co.

North Africa — Operation Torch and Tunisia (Nov 1942 – May 1943)

Date	Location	Event	Source
Nov 8, 1942	Safi, French Morocco (32.30°N, 9.24°W)	OPERATION TORCH — Landing at Safi (Henry's combat debut). Sub-Task Force Blackstone reached the transport area 8 miles off Safi at 2330 the night before. At 0430 the destroyers <i>Bernadou</i> (Co. K) and <i>Cole</i> (Co. I) ran straight into Safi Harbor — guided by an infra-red lamp a submarine-landed party had set on the jetty — and put their assault companies ashore under coast-gun and machine-gun fire; the battleship <i>New York</i> silenced the 130mm Pt. de la Tour battery by 0445. The 1st Battalion Landing Team (Henry's battalion), commanded by Major Frederick C. Feil , came in on the morning waves: Co. A at 0525, Co. B (Red Beach) 0500, Co. C (Green Beach) 0530, and Company D landed on Blue Beach at 0705 against enemy artillery fire. The 1st Bn advance was held up about an hour by rifle and MG fire from the high ground east of the harbor before clearing its objectives. (<i>The H Co. history's generic "first troops landed ~0900" reflects the later, delayed 2nd/3rd Bn waves; the regimental history gives the earlier 1st Bn / D Co. times above.</i>)	History of the 47th Inf 1940–42 (S22) / H Co.
Nov 9, 1942	Safi	Marched to positions south of Safi; defensive positions established	H Co.
Nov 10–11, 1942	Safi	Armistice between French and American forces	H Co.
Nov 12, 1942	Safi	Garrison camp established; training program started	H Co.
Nov 16, 1942	Safi	First mail received since leaving the States	H Co.
Nov 22, 1942	Safi	Memorial services for men killed during occupation; General Harmon presided; Purple Hearts and Silver Stars presented	H Co.
Dec 4, 1942	Safi	Moved to new bivouac in the Athletic Stadium	H Co.

Date	Location	Event	Source
Dec 25, 1942	Safi	Christmas dinner; church services	H Co.
Jan 1, 1943	Safi / Port Lyautey (34.27°N, 6.58°W)	D Company at Port Lyautey; usual camp duties	D Co.
Jan 1943	Port Lyautey / Spanish Morocco border	Secret border patrol mission. The 47th received secret orders to patrol the Spanish Moroccan border. General Franco had an estimated 150,000 troops in Spanish Morocco; while Franco pledged neutrality, the Allies patrolled as a precaution. The 1st Battalion (Henry's battalion) was first to get the assignment; after a week along the frontier, relieved by the 3rd Battalion	47th IR History (S17)
Jan 19, 1943	Port Lyautey	47th Combat Team formally dissolved per 9th Infantry Division Daily Bulletin No. 19	47th IR History (S17)
Jan 22, 1943	Port Lyautey (34.27°N, 6.58°W)	President Roosevelt visited Port Lyautey. FDR flew to Casablanca for the historic Casablanca Conference with British PM Winston Churchill. He made a motor trip to Port Lyautey accompanied by Allied Force commanders. A combat team review was staged seven miles southwest of Port Lyautey for the visiting President by the 3rd Battalion of the 47th Infantry and the 1st and 2nd Battalions of the 60th Infantry. The Regimental Reconnaissance and Intelligence Platoon served as guard of honor when the President visited the cemetery for American dead at Mehdia, outside Port Lyautey	47th IR History (S17)
Jan 29–30, 1943	Port Lyautey, French Morocco	Left Safi by rail (250 miles); French civilians lined streets to bid farewell; regimental band played	H Co.
Feb 4, 1943	Port Lyautey	Company B, 9th Medical Battalion; one platoon of Company B, 15th Engineers; and the 84th Field Artillery Battalion attached to the 47th per 9th Infantry Division Special Order No. 28	47th IR History (S17)
Feb 6–8, 1943	Tlemcen, Algeria (34.88°N, 1.32°W)	Moved by rail to Tlemcen, Algeria	H Co.
Feb 8–11, 1943	Port Lyautey → Eastward	D Company loaded equipment on train; departed for new area	D Co.

Date	Location	Event	Source
Feb 12–21, 1943	Across Algeria	Long march/truck shuttle movement across Algeria (~700 miles total): Oran, Afreville, Oued Fodda, Medea, Arba, Ain M'Lila	H Co./D Co.
Feb 26, 1943	Tebessa, Algeria (35.40°N, 8.12°E)	Arrived bivouac near Tebessa	D Co./H Co.
Feb 27, 1943	Kasserine Pass, Tunisia (35.17°N, 8.73°E)	Moved to defensive positions; relieved elements of 16th Infantry, 1st Infantry Division	D Co./H Co.
Mar 3–24, 1943	Kasserine Pass	Defensive positions covering entrance to the pass. Barbed wire entanglements constructed. German planes strafed positions on the 12th — one shot down by small arms fire	D Co./H Co.
Mar 25–26, 1943	Kasserine → Gafsa (34.43°N, 8.78°E) → El Guettar	Left defensive positions; moved by truck to Gafsa (67 miles); at 2200 moved to assembly area east of El Guettar for attack	D Co./H Co.
Mar 28, 1943	El Guettar, Tunisia (34.32°N, 8.95°E)	BATTLE OF EL GUETTAR BEGINS. 2nd Bn attacked at 0535; Company E, in the lead, caught in cross machine gun fire — lost 5 officers and 174 enlisted men including CO Capt. Ben K. Humphrey. Company G lost 1 officer and 30 men; Company F lost CO Capt. Francis M. Smith, XO, and 5 men. Capt. Horace M. Spaulding (H Company) and Lt. Crane Campbell (aide to General Eisenhower) also missing with Company E. Lt. Col. Louis Gershenow (2nd Bn CO), 1st Lt. Willard G. Duckworth (Bn S-2), and 2nd Lt. Sidney A. Thal (Bn comms officer) captured. 1st Bn advanced under intense MG, mortar, and artillery fire; Company A reached low hills near Hill 369, suffering many casualties. 1st Lt. Ray I. Inzer appointed commander of H Company, replacing Capt. Spaulding. D Company attacked at dawn. KIA: Pvt Bragg, Pvt Hildreth, Pvt Dietz. WIA: 2nd Lt. Kennelly, Col. Lukas	D Co./H Co./47th IR History (S17)
Mar 29, 1943	El Guettar	Fighting continues. D Company WIA evacuated: Gittinger, Valentino, Knoblauch, Long, Grimes. MIA: Cpl Shopa, PFC Garofalo, Pvt Harnaga. KIA: PFC Peter D. Manaresi (32066459), Pvt Jimlo (<i>name confirmed from the regiment's Africa KIA honor roll and the 1943-history Tunisia casualty list, both of which list "Manaresi, Peter D., Co. D, Posthumous"</i>)	D Co. / Africa KIA Honor Roll (S20)

Date	Location	Event	Source
Mar 30 – Apr 6, 1943	El Guettar	Sustained combat for 9 days. Heavy artillery daily. D Company suffered additional WIA each day. Relieved by 15th Engineers on Apr 6	D Co./H Co.
Apr 7, 1943	El Guettar	Enemy withdrew; advanced 8 miles	D Co.
Mar 28 – Apr 7, 1943	El Guettar	H Company casualties at El Guettar. KIA: PFC Grover E. Jones, PFC Earl J. Nutt (38081478), PFC Michael Kosar. MIA: Capt. Horace M. Spaulding (0-326238), 1st Lt. Charles I. Victor (O-1384437), Sgt. Clifford B. Saxton (32057279), Cpl. Rudolph A. Komerak (32066535), Cpl. Joseph D. Mazzari (31035714), Pvt Robert Lloyd (32003410), Pvt Hillis McGee (15098245). Silver Star Awards for Gallantry in Action, El Guettar, 28 Mar – 7 Apr 43: Sgt. Edward Gold (32057624), Cpl. Domenic E. Padula (31056587), PFC Michael Schork (2003380), PFC Jack Lovett (14123290), PFC Earl J. Nutt (38081478, also KIA), PFC William S. Quincy (36312932), PFC Harold I. Morancy (31045017), Pvt Paul E. [surname illegible] (37207209), Sgt. Harry J. Lee (31056714), Cpl. Harvey N. Painter (38081592). Additionally, 18 aid men were recommended for Silver Stars by company commanders; other Medical Detachment members recommended for Legion of Merit. Medical Detachment suffered 22 casualties out of 126 men (3 KIA, 3 captured, 16 WIA)	H Co. Casualty Roster / 47th IR History (S17)
Apr 8, 1943	Bou Hebka, near Tebessa, Algeria	Moved by truck 70 miles to Bou Hebka; bivouac reached at dusk; pup tents pitched for first time since Kasserine Pass. Men caught first full night's sleep in two weeks	47th IR History (S17)
Apr 9, 1943	Bou Hebka, Algeria	Company E reconstituted. 430 enlisted men and 26 lieutenants arrived as replacements. Of this total, 133 enlisted men and 5 lieutenants were formed into a new Company E, replacing Captain Humphrey's ill-fated unit. Only 33 of the original Company E remained — cooks, drivers, hospital cases, and detached service men. 1st Lt. William Larson transferred from Company A to command the new company	47th IR History (S17)
Apr 15, 1943	Sedjanane area	22 experienced NCOs transferred from other companies to take command of key positions in the reconstituted Company E	47th IR History (S17)
Apr 16, 1943	Sedjanane area	Capt. Randall Bryant relieved from Regimental S-2 to become executive officer of the 1st Battalion; succeeded as S-2 by 1st Lt. James H. Cameron	47th IR History (S17)

Date	Location	Event	Source
Apr 11–12, 1943	Sedjanane, Tunisia (37.06°N, 9.24°E)	Moved by British lorries under strict blackout, 65 miles to defensive positions 4 miles east of Sedjanane; relieved troops of the 138th Brigade, British 1st Army, in the line west of Bald and Green hills. 12 mules received from the British for transporting food, water, and ammunition over the mountainous terrain	D Co./H Co./47th IR History (S17)
Apr 23, 1943	Sedjanane area	Attack began at 0530; D Company machine guns and mortars fired in support. Moved forward with mules under fire. The S-3 journal records the regiment fighting through the Bald/Green/Sugarloaf hill mass east of Sedjanane, with artillery firing identification smoke onto named hills (Baldy 1000, Green 1030, Sugarloaf 1100) and rations, water, and ammunition carried forward by mule	D Co./H Co./47th IR S-3 Journal
May 4–7, 1943	Near Bizerte, Tunisia (37.27°N, 9.87°E)	Moved toward Bizerte; D Company in mobile reserve. H Company attacked Hills 208 and 223. May 6: the 1st Battalion (Henry's) made a light advance into Bizerte; "On" (Cannon) Company fired on five enemy guns and destroyed two or three; the Germans had planted demolitions and mines in important buildings throughout the city, with heavy artillery firing from across the channel (Goulet du Lac). May 7: Gen. Eddy and staff forward at the CP; the 47th advanced to within ~1 mile east of Bizerte and dug in against a possible counterattack from across Goulet du Lac, supported by the 75th Tank Bn and 9th Div artillery	D Co./H Co./47th IR S-3 Journal
May 8, 1943	Bizerte, Tunisia	Arrived in Bizerte area; defensive positions consolidated. Naval/air activity reported offshore (transports, destroyers, submarines with barrage balloons)	D Co./H Co./47th IR S-3 Journal
May 9, 1943	Bizerte–Tunis area	End of the North African campaign. Per the S-3 journal: "Genl Harmon in conference with German officers for surrender of troops in area between Tunis and Bizerte." Organized Axis resistance in the sector collapsed	47th IR S-3 Journal
May 10, 1943	Bizerte	"47th Inf relieved from alert" (0800, S-3 journal). Marched through Bizerte; D Company worked on docks	D Co./47th IR S-3 Journal
May 19–24, 1943	Algeria (long convoy)	Moved by truck westward across Algeria: Bone (36.76°N, 7.76°E) → Constantine (36.37°N, 6.61°E) → Sidi Bel Abbes (35.19°N, 0.63°W) (~600 miles)	D Co./H Co.

Date	Location	Event	Source
Jun 4–7, 1943	Oran, Algeria (35.70°N, 0.63°W)	3-day rest near Oran; swimming, visiting town	D Co./H Co.
Jun 14, 1943	La Senia Airport, Algeria (35.63°N, 0.62°W)	King George VI inspected and reviewed assembled troops of the 47th; commended their appearance. Per the regiment's African diary, the 47th furnished a Guard of Honor for the King , and Lt. Gen. Mark Clark (Fifth Army commander) presented the 2nd Battalion to him as " <i>the crack battalion of the crack regiment of the crack 9th Infantry Division.</i> " The documented review centers on the 2nd Battalion; it is not recorded whether Henry's own 1st Battalion was among the units on parade.	H Co. / African Diary (S20)
Jun 16 – Jul 8, 1943	Magenta, Algeria	Vigorous training and physical conditioning	D Co./H Co.
Jul 9–14, 1943	Algeria (road march)	Series of night road marches (~100 miles total) from Magenta area to Bou Sfer	D Co./H Co.
Jul 15–27, 1943	Bou Sfer, Algeria (35.73°N, 0.86°W)	Camp duties; training	D Co./H Co.

Voyage to Sicily (Jul–Aug 1943)

Date	Location	Event	Source
Jul 28, 1943	Oran, Algeria (35.70°N, 0.63°W)	Boarded USAT Shawnee	D Co./H Co.
Jul 29, 1943	At sea	Departed Oran at 1030	D Co./H Co.
Aug 1, 1943	Palermo, Sicily (38.12°N, 13.36°E)	Air raid at 0400; disembarked; marched ~10-12 miles to bivouac south of Palermo	D Co./H Co.

Sicily Campaign (Aug–Nov 1943)

Note on Henry's track during Sicily: the morning-report record shows Henry was on detached duty for part of this campaign. On Oct 13, 1943 he returned to Company D duty from Special Duty, 9th Quartermaster Battalion; barely a day later, effective Oct 14, 1943, he was reassigned from Company D duty to Detached Service, Headquarters, Seventh Army, and returned to Company D duty from that DS stint on Oct 24, 1943 (see rows below — corrected 2026-07-14 against the original scanned images). The exact start of the QM detachment is not documented, but it means the August Troina–Cesaro–Randazzo fighting recorded below is D Company's story; Henry is not documented to have been present for it — for at least some of the campaign he was serving away from the line. His Sicily campaign star covers weeks the records only partly preserve. [S18]

Date	Location	Event	Source
Aug 4, 1943	Nicosia, Sicily (37.75°N, 14.40°E)	Moved ~124-130 miles by truck to area east of Nicosia	D Co./H Co.
Aug 6, 1943	Troina, Sicily (37.78°N, 14.63°E)	Marched cross-country over mountainous terrain to Troina area	D Co./H Co.
Aug 7, 1943	Troina → Cesaro, Sicily (37.78°N, 14.63°E → 37.85°N, 14.71°E)	Contact with German forces. 0400: 3d Bn led the advance (preceded by 9th Recon Troop and I&R Platoon), followed by 2d and 1st Bns. 0740: Heavy artillery began falling along the road east of Troina — casualties in I&R Platoon and 1st Battalion . D Company halted by heavy enemy artillery at 0930. German artillery described as “the heaviest of any part of the campaign”; 6-barrel Nebelwerfers employed. 1st Bn ordered to send recon patrols for a wide encirclement. 1955: New plan — 2d Bn to pass through 3d Bn at 2200 and seize Cesaro; 1st Bn ordered to send 2 companies with MG platoon attached around left flank to assist capture of Cesaro. Remainder of 1st Bn to protect right flank. H Company moved forward in support of battalion attack. All 9th Division units advanced at least 3,000 yards this day	D Co./H Co./ 47th IR S-3 Journal/9th Div Report

Date	Location	Event	Source
Aug 8, 1943	Cesaro, Sicily (~37.84°N, 14.76°E)	0655: "Receiving no opposition at daylight, the 47th Infantry moved to the outskirts of Cesaro." Town heavily mined; demolished bridges throughout. 0725: Companies A and B (1st Bn) with MG platoon moving north to flank Cesaro — 1st Bn companies in action flanking the town. 0900: MGs manned by men in civilian clothes fired on E Company; platoon flanked the gun and killed the crew. 1110: 2d Bn entered Cesaro. "The capture of Cesaro by the 47th Infantry broke the southern anchor of the German San Agata–Cesaro defensive line." 1545: 1st Bn ordered to Hill I at grid (6913) / ~37.88°N, 14.78°E. 2000: 1st Bn on ridge 1.5 miles east of Cesaro; halted by artillery. D Company reconnaissance — jeep hit a mine: PFC Camacho KIA; Sgt Wright and PFC Zarek WIA	D Co./47th IR S-3 Journal/9th Div Report
Aug 9, 1943	East of Cesaro (~37.83°N, 14.80°E)	0600: 1st Bn leading elements reached grid (650160) / ~37.82°N, 14.77°E. 1020: Col. Smythe reports 1st Bn meeting resistance at grid (675170) / ~37.83°N, 14.80°E — small arms fire from enemy positions. H Company: PFC Nutt and PFC Jones killed by enemy artillery at 0400; PFC Fournier severely wounded. D Company moved through heavy artillery barrage without breaking ranks. Capt. Sieminiski (Cannon Co.) on his own initiative moved Cannon Company into position at grid (665145) / ~37.85°N, 14.77°E and shelled Cast di Bolo for an hour, neutralizing hostile MG and mortar fire. Lt. Col. Clayman assumed command of 3d Bn, replacing Maj. Labbitt (relieved). German prisoner intelligence: covering force told to hold until ammunition expended, then escape — "no defense in depth"	D Co./H Co./47th IR S-3 Journal
Aug 10, 1943	Cast di Bolo area (~37.88°N, 14.78°E)	1230: 3d Bn occupied Cast di Bolo. D Company attacked; halted by heavy fire. Capt. Niven directed mortar fire, knocking out enemy machine gun nests. Multiple WIA. 1st Bn S-2 mine intelligence: road east to Randazzo mined with AT and AP mines along both shoulders; three intact Mark IV tanks found in river bed east of Cast di Bolo — out of gas, heavily booby-trapped and mined , covering the valley. 39th Infantry ordered to pass through 47th Infantry on night of Aug 10-11 for final push to Randazzo; 47th went into Division Reserve	D Co./47th IR S-3 Journal/9th Div Report

Date	Location	Event	Source
Aug 11–13, 1943	Cesaro → Randazzo area	47th IR in Division Reserve. 0645 Aug 11: 39th Infantry passed through 47th. Aug 12: 1st Bn given new mission — A Company (reinforced with MG platoon) outposted hill at grid (7323) / ~37.82°N, 14.89°E to protect field artillery. Aug 13: 47th IR ordered to assembly area at grid (798228) / ~37.88°N, 14.95°E, vicinity of Randazzo; prepared to attack Randazzo and seize high ground east of Floresta. 1st Bn CP at (788219) / ~37.88°N, 14.93°E. 1120: One battalion of 39th reported in Randazzo	47th IR S-3 Journal
Aug 14–16, 1943	Randazzo area, Sicily (37.88°N, 14.95°E)	Moved to area west of Randazzo. “4th Div has been pinched out.” 47th IR ordered to stay in present area 3-4 days awaiting further orders	D Co./H Co./ 47th IR S-3 Journal
Aug 22, 1943	Cefalu, Sicily (38.04°N, 14.02°E)	Moved by truck to bivouac near Cefalu; airport guard duty	D Co./H Co.
Aug 26, 1943	Sicily (9th Div. area)	All NCOs and officers attended a speech by General Patton in the 9th Division area	1st Bn Journal (S15)
~Sep 11, 1943	Sicily (Corps area)	Al Jolson performed a USO show in the corps area; members of the 1st Battalion were taken to the show in trucks	1st Bn Journal (S15)
Sep 16, 1943	Sicily	Major General Keyes, 2nd Corps Commander, inspected the regiment	H Co.
Sep 22, 1943	Sicily (Div. area)	Jack Benny and cast performed a USO show for troops of the 9th Division	1st Bn Journal (S15)
Sep 23, 1943	Sicily	First men left for the U.S. under the rotation plan	H Co.
Oct 7–9, 1943	Termini Imerese, Sicily (37.99°N, 13.70°E)	Division beach defense problem/exercise	D Co./H Co.
Oct 13, 1943	6 mi E of Termini Imerese, Sicily (~37.99°N, 13.79°E)	Henry returned to Company D duty from Special Duty, 9th Quartermaster Battalion , effective 0600. Two other EM (Cpl. Barone, Pvt. Klepfer) returned on the same report	Morning Report, NARA Cat. 454439085 p.572 (S18)

Date	Location	Event	Source
Oct 18, 1943 report (effective Oct 14)	6 mi E of Termini Imerese, Sicily	Henry reassigned from Company D duty to Detached Service, Headquarters, Seventh Army , effective the 14th — barely a day after returning from QM duty. Two other EM (Pvt. Evensen, Pvt. Klepfer) went out on the same orders. <i>(Correction, 2026-07-14: an earlier version of this entry had the direction reversed, describing this as a return to the 47th. The scanned image reads “Above named 4 EM fr duty to DS Hq 7th Army - 14th” — a departure, not a return.)</i>	Morning Report, NARA Cat. 454439085 p.580 (S18)
Oct 24, 1943	6 mi E of Termini Imerese, Sicily	Henry returned to Company D duty from Detached Service, Headquarters, Seventh Army , effective 1600 — a ~10-day DS stint (Oct 14–24). Pvt. Dupuy returned on the same orders	Morning Report, NARA Cat. 454439085 p.591 (S18)
Oct 26, 1943	Sicily	General Patton reviewed the division and presented awards	H Co.
Nov 3, 1943	Sicily	All insignia and unit markings removed from clothing prior to move (OPSEC)	H Co.
Nov 5–9, 1943	Mondello / Palermo, Sicily	Moved to staging area; prepared for embarkation	D Co./H Co.

Voyage to England (Nov 1943)

Date	Location	Event	Source
Nov 9–10, 1943	Palermo Harbor	Boarded USS John Ericsson; departed at 2230 on Nov 10	D Co./H Co.
Nov 12, 1943	At sea	Air raid alerts; unidentified planes spotted	H Co.
Nov 14, 1943	Strait of Gibraltar (35.97°N, 5.50°W)	Passed the Rock of Gibraltar at 0615	H Co.
Nov 25, 1943	Liverpool, England (53.41°N, 2.99°W)	Anchored at 0600; disembarked at 1400	H Co.

Date	Location	Event	Source
Nov 26, 1943	Cheriton / Tichborne / Alresford, Hampshire, England (51.07°N, 1.14°W)	Arrived by rail to billets near Winchester , ~50 miles SW of London. Per the regimental history, the regiment was dispersed across villages of the Itchen valley, and the 1st Battalion's companies were split among separate villages: 1st Bn HQ & HQ Co at Alresford; Companies A, B, and C at Tichborne; and Henry's Company "D" billeted by itself at Cheriton. (Regt HQ and the Antitank, Cannon & Service Companies were at Northington Grange; 2nd Bn HQ and Company H at Armsworth House; Cos E & F at Brighton Wood; Co G at Bishop Sutton; 3rd Bn in/near Basingstoke.) Cheriton, Tichborne, and Alresford sit within ~2–3 miles of one another. By January 1944 the Company D history and Henry's later morning reports place D Company at Tichborne (the Feb 1944 furlough report names Tichborne) — a short relocation within the same cluster, or use of the larger village's name for the battalion area. H Company at Nissen shelters near Alresford. Newspaper confirms Henry was “sent to England in December, 1943” — consistent with late November arrival and December settling-in. Note: the 25th General Hospital was at this time establishing at nearby Stockbridge, Hampshire — just ~8 miles from Tichborne/Alresford. It moved to Cirencester in March 1944, then handed the Cirencester hospital plant over to the 192nd General Hospital on May 20, 1944. When Henry was wounded the following month, he was treated by the 192nd at the same Cirencester plant — not the 25th, which had moved on to Fargo Plains, Wiltshire, en route to France	D Co./H Co./ Newspaper/ 47th IR History (S17)

England — Training for D-Day (Dec 1943 – Jun 1944)

Date	Location	Event	Source
Dec 1, 1943	Hampshire, England	Vigorous training schedule started	H Co.
Dec 24–26, 1943	Hampshire, England	Christmas holiday; dinner and refreshments	H Co.
Jan 19, 1944	Alresford, England	General Montgomery addressed the troops; welcomed them to England, spoke of past campaigns and future cooperation	H Co.

Date	Location	Event	Source
Feb 4, 1944	Tichborne, Hampshire, England (51.07°N, 1.14°W)	Henry departed on furlough. Morning report names him going on furlough from his unit at Tichborne	Morning Report, NARA Cat. 464593435 p.631 (S18)
Feb 14, 1944	Tichborne, Hampshire, England	Henry returned from furlough — 10-day leave, his only documented leave between arriving in England (Nov 1943) and D-Day	Morning Report, NARA Cat. 464593435 p.654 (S18)
Feb 11–28, 1944	Hampshire, England	Primary and secondary weapons range firing	H Co.
Mar 11–22, 1944	Herriard / Tidworth, England	Battalion training problems; moved to Tidworth for live-fire infantry-tank attack exercises	D Co./H Co.
Mar 24, 1944	Alresford, England	Prime Minister Churchill and General Eisenhower reviewed the troops on the Alresford–Basingstoke highway. Churchill accompanied by General Eddy (9th Division commander)	H Co.
Mar 28, 1944	Hampshire, England	1-year anniversary of Battle of El Guettar; Capt. Inzer treated company to beer at the pub	H Co.
Apr 9–10, 1944	Shrewton area, England	Large live-fire exercise ~50 miles from base; live ammunition fired over riflemen	H Co.
May 1, 1944	Hampshire, England	Alerted for departure overseas	Eng/Fr docx
May 2–6, 1944	Southampton marshalling area	Dress rehearsal for invasion. Company left Tichborne by rail and motor at 0925, arrived marshalling area near Southampton at 1125. Received instructions on waterproofing weapons and equipment. Returned to Tichborne on May 7	Eng/Fr docx

Date	Location	Event	Source
May 16, 1944	Hampshire, England	Division competitive firing for machine gun platoons	H Co.
May 18, 1944	Hampshire, England (HQ 47th Inf, APO #9)	HENRY AWARDED COMBAT INFANTRYMAN BADGE. General Orders No. 5, 47th Infantry, “Award of Combat Infantryman Badges,” awards the CIB under War Department Circular 269 (27 Oct 1943) to officers and enlisted men of Company “D”, 47th Inf. Pfc Henry F Matola, ASN 15013984 named on the Company D list — documentary confirmation of the CIB (the anchor for the derivative Bronze Star). Pfc George Kysilka, ASN 15013985, is on the same Co. D list (3 lines above Henry)	GO No. 5, 47th Inf, 18 May 1944 — photos/nara/Box6495/...1944-GO_2026/IMG_3753.jpeg (Co. D list IMG_3752→3751→3753; NARA frame 6-2585; NND 735017)
May 26, 1944	Hampshire, England	Col. Smythe addressed battalion on the regiment’s part in forthcoming operations	H Co.
Jun 1–5, 1944	Hampshire, England	Final preparations for marshalling area	D Co./H Co./Eng/Fr docx
Jun 2, 1944	Hampshire, England (HQ 47th Inf, APO #9)	HENRY AWARDED DRIVERS AND MECHANICS BADGE (Driver–W). General Orders No. 10, 47th Infantry, awards the badge under War Department Circular 248 (1942) to Pfc Henry F Matola, ASN 15013984 , Company “D” (Pfc George Kysilka, ASN 15013985, also on the Co. D list)	GO No. 10, 47th Inf, 2 Jun 1944 — photos/nara/Box6495/...1944-GO_2026/IMG_3777.jpeg

D-Day and Normandy (Jun–Aug 1944)

Henry F. Matola, PFC, is listed on the official 1st Battalion, 47th Infantry Regiment “Normandy Campaign — Wounded in Action” roster (309-INF(47)-0.1 EU wounded 1 44 to 12 44.pdf, page 11). Listed as “Private First Class — Matola, Henry F.” George Kysilka also appears on the same roster (page 10, OCR’d as “Kysilka, George”). The roster covers Headquarters Company,

Companies A, B, C, and D of the 1st Battalion. Additionally, Henry appears on the D Company cumulative casualty list (Doc 2, p.66) covering landing through 30 September 1944, listed as WIA. [S5/S9]

Date	Location	Event	Source
Jun 6, 1944	Southampton marshalling area (50.91°N, 1.40°W)	D-DAY. Left Alresford approx 1700, proceeded to the marshalling area, arrived approx 0130 on 7 June (per D Co.'s own daily morning report, S26 — supersedes the earlier “moved to marshalling area at 0230” figure from the D Co. narrative history). Intensive map reconnaissance of invasion area. Waterproofing weapons	D Co./D Co. Morning Report (S26)
Jun 7, 1944	Marshalling area, England	“Usual camp duties” per the company’s daily morning report — no individual changes	D Co. Morning Report (S26)
Jun 8, 1944	Aboard LCT #16	Left the marshalling area and boarded LCT #16 at about 1600 (D Co.'s own daily morning report, S26). This conflicts with the “turned away from the docks, returned 1400, boarded transport at 2100” account below (sourced to the 1st Bn Journal covering Companies A, B, and D collectively) — D Company’s own record shows a direct, uninterrupted boarding with no mention of a failed first attempt. Treated as an open discrepancy between two primary-adjacent sources, not resolved; the 1st Bn Journal account may describe a different company or the battalion as a whole rather than D Company specifically. <i>(Prior “turned away” account, retained for the record: Companies A, B, and D left marshalling area for the docks but were turned away — no landing craft or ships available. Returned at 1400. Successfully boarded transport bound for France at 2100.)</i>	D Co. Morning Report (S26) / D Co./H Co./ 1st Bn Journal
Jun 9, 1944	Aboard LCT #16	“No Change,” “usual ship duties” per the company’s daily morning report	D Co. Morning Report (S26)

Date	Location	Event	Source
Jun 10, 1944	Aboard LCT #16 → disembarked France	Still aboard LCT #16 as of the report's 2400 cutoff ("No Change"); the following day's report clarifies: "Disembarked about 2100 10 June 44 and proceeded to St Mere Eglise, France to bivouac area" (D Co.'s own daily morning report, S26 — supersedes the "~1800" figure from the D Co. narrative history; note this primary daily record names no beach at all , neither Utah nor Omaha). D Company and medics arrived ~24 hours before the rest of 1st Battalion on a separate ship. Transferred from transport to LCTs and LCIs. Bombed and strafed during move inland. Marched to 9th Division transit area near Sebeville (Regimental CP at grid 372945 / ~49.37°N, 1.28°W), then to bivouac near St. Mere-Eglise. Fields littered with airborne gliders from the D-Day landings. Corroboration that D Co. landed ahead of the regiment: the 47th IR Unit Journal records that when Regimental HQ established the CP at Sebeville on 11 Jun at 2320B , "D' Co had already landed" — the regiment's main body (Regt HQ + remainder of 1st Bn) did not unload until 11 June (D+5) per the AAR, with other companies disembarking 12 June. (<i>The D Co. history names the landing beach "Omaha" in error — the 9th Division landed across Utah Beach; the company's own daily morning report, the more contemporaneous document, doesn't name a beach at all.</i>)	D Co. Morning Report (S26) / D Co./H Co./47th IR Cherbourg History/1st Bn Journal/47th IR Unit Journal/47th IR AAR
Jun 11, 1944	St Mere Eglise, France	"No Change" per the company's daily morning report; "usual bivouac duties"	D Co. Morning Report (S26)
Jun 12, 1944	9th Division area, Normandy	Maps distributed; general situation briefings conducted across the division. D Co.'s own morning report confirms St Mere Eglise, "no change," "usual bivouac duties"	47th IR Cherbourg History / D Co. Morning Report (S26)

Note on Henry's individual presence, Jun 6–15 (updated 2026-07-09, re: the DUKW/hospital-ship family account under investigation — see [[project-henry-dday-dukwhypothesis]] and the DUKW research plan in data/nara/d day version 2/): D Company's own daily morning reports for this entire window are now in hand (S26, 1–17 June 1944, supplied by the family 2026-07-09) — a materially stronger source than the monthly-interval gap previously documented. Henry's own morning-report trail still has no document individually naming him between Jun 2, 1944 (GO No. 10, Driver-Mechanics Badge, HQ 47th Inf, Hampshire England) and Jun 16, 1944 (Co. D morning report, wounded, Normandy) — but it is now known that this is not a gap in the surviving record, since the company's complete day-by-day reports for the intervening period are held and show, on every single day from 1 through 15 June, "No Change"

for Henry specifically, alongside individually-recorded changes for other soldiers (sick call, promotions, records corrections) on several of those same days. If Henry had been detached to a DUKW crew for any part of 6–10 June, the company's own paperwork was demonstrably capable of recording far smaller individual events during this exact window, and no such entry for him exists. His presence with D Company through the marshalling, LCT #16 crossing, and disembarkation is therefore implied by the company's daily reports as a matter of default (he was never individually pulled out of the collective "No Change" status), though it remains true that no single document affirmatively places him on Utah Beach by name on a specific day — see S26 for the full analysis of what this narrows and what it still leaves open. 2026-07-10: a read-only NARA Catalog API key was requested (emailed to Catalog_API@nara.gov) as a remote path to search the 478th/462nd/479th Amphibian Truck Companies' morning reports directly, once issued — see the DUKW research plan and [dukw-case-summary.pdf](#) for status. | Jun 13, 1944 | Ecoqueneauville / Caponnell, France | ~1615: First field order received from division. Main objective of 9th Division: **drive to the sea and seal off the Cherbourg Peninsula**. General Eddy (9th Div. commander) briefed regimental COs. Battalion and company commanders visited 9th Division's combat area ahead. 1st Bn order of march: A, B, Hq, C, D. Bn staff and Co Commanders met at 2310, bivouacked near Caponnell | 47th IR Cherbourg History/1st Bn Journal | | Jun 14, 1944 | Gourbesville / Merderet River | 60th Infantry committed as assault regiment at 0835; 1st Bn is Division Reserve. 47th IR crossed the Merderet River at Gourbesville. D Company moved forward to assembly area — 1st Bn order of march: B, C, D, Hq, A, AT; walked ~2 miles to bivouac. **1st Bn commanded by Lt. Col. Den T. Vanderhoef** | D Co./47th IR Cherbourg History/1st Bn Journal | | **Jun 15, 1944 | Near Orglandes, France (grid 253977–247977 / ~49.396°N, 1.449°W to ~49.396°N, 1.457°W) | FIRST COMBAT IN FRANCE.** 0935: Gen. Eddy and Col. Smythe arrived at 1st Bn CP (grid 275955 / ~49.376°N, 1.418°W) to brief staff and company commanders. 1041: 1st Bn moved out leading the regiment; order of march: **A, B, C, D, Hq**. Snipers harassed the march the entire ~6 miles. SP gun shells landed near the road. Small arms fire nearly continuous. By ~1715, companies deployed: C, B, A forward; D in support. 1st Bn front line reached grid **(253977) / ~49.396°N, 1.449°W–(247977) / ~49.396°N, 1.457°W** by evening. At ~1900, **Sgt. Graeff's squad took a direct mortar hit at grid (251974) / ~49.394°N, 1.451°W** — Pvt. Groves KIA; Sgt. Graeff, Pvts. Raimondo, Falconiero, Rollins & Benethum WIA. Enemy fire came from mortars, SP guns, and a battery in the vicinity of **Orglandes** (grid 252972 / ~49.392°N, 1.450°W). 2015: Artillery fire requested on Orglandes. Three D Company men wounded per D Co. history. Attached units supporting 1st Bn included Co. B, 746th Tank Bn and Co. B, 899th Tank Destroyer Bn. H Company: 1 WIA | D Co./H Co./1st Bn Journal/47th IR Unit Journal/47th IR AA Report | | **Jun 16, 1944 | Orglandes area, France (1st Bn CP at grid 261960 / ~49.381°N, 1.438°W) | HENRY MATOLA WOUNDED.** 1st and 3rd Bns continued attack; 1st Bn assigned successive objectives D-F-G. 0750: Artillery from Orglandes hit A Company, then shifted SW. 0830: "1st Bn receiving mortar fire from vicinity of

ORGLANDES.” 0855: Suspected counterattack from Reigneville (grid 236967 / ~49.387°N, 1.472°W); artillery and high-velocity gun fire from Orglandes hit 1st Bn right flank. Company positions at ~0950: C Co at (252980) / ~49.399°N, 1.450°W, B Co at (249975) / ~49.394°N, 1.454°W, A Co at (253974) / ~49.394°N, 1.449°W. **Henry hit by shrapnel.** The Co. D morning report records his wound as “**shrap jaw and chest**” and classifies him **SWA (Seriously Wounded in Action)**; the **305th Station Hospital Admission & Disposition report (S23)** records “**Pen W rt shoulder sv**” (penetrating wound, right shoulder, severe); his later SGO Hospital Admission Card codes the principal site as the **neck** — together describing one artillery-shell-fragment burst across the right side (jaw, neck, chest, shoulder), corroborating the family’s account in full. **PFC George Kysilka hit by shrapnel to the right leg (also “SWA”) in the same engagement.** Both had consecutive service numbers — they enlisted together at Fort Hayes, Columbus, Ohio on October 13, 1940 and served side by side through Africa, Sicily, and into Normandy. Both evacuated to the **Clearing Company, 9th Medical Battalion** (their division’s own medical battalion), then to hospitals in England (hospital unknown). Dropped from company rolls this date. By 0900: casualty NCO reported 15 casualties, 1 dead, 1 missing. By 1200: **total 1st Bn casualties — 1 KIA, 20 EM WIA, 2 officers WIA, 2 sick evacuated** (Henry among the 20 WIA). 1017: C Co commander injured; Lt. Morgan of B Co injured. That afternoon, **Lt. Glider (D Co.),** Lt. Bowles, and Pvt. Garrison were attacked ~400 yards NE of A Co’s position; their vehicle was set on fire — **Lt. Glider, although severely wounded, removed another officer and the body of his driver from the burning vehicle** (awarded Bronze Star for this action). Bowles and Garrison presumed KIA. By day’s end, 1st Bn had advanced through Hautteville Bocage (grid 238987 / ~49.405°N, 1.469°W) to positions astride the St. Sauveur-Valognes road. H Company: heaviest fire ever laid by company; Canville taken. **The Co. D morning report’s station line reads “vicinity of Picauville” (~49.34°N, 1.41°W — west of the Merderet)** — the company’s location of record that day; consistent with the 1st Bn axis of advance through Hautteville Bocage toward St. Sauveur-Valognes | D Co./H Co./Morning Report/Newspaper/1st Bn Journal/47th IR Unit Journal/47th IR AA Report/Morning Report, NARA Cat. 478540412 p.622 (S18) | | Jun 17–18, 1944 | Evacuation chain, Normandy → English Channel | (*Henry’s track:*) Per Henry’s Hospital Admission Card (Office of the Surgeon General), Henry spent **1 day in an Evacuation Hospital** in Normandy — Jun 17 at the evac hospital; Jun 18 in transit across the Channel. The morning report filed Jun 18 listed both Henry and George as “Hosp unknown,” consistent with mid-transit. The **25th General Hospital** had vacated the Cirencester hospital plant on **May 20, 1944**, formally handing it over to the **192nd General Hospital** that date; the 25th was at Fargo Plains, Wiltshire (May 20 – Jun 21), then Tidworth, and did not cross the Channel until late July 1944. Henry was therefore treated by the **192nd General Hospital** at Plant 4150 — not the 25th. The SGO Hospital Admission Card “Final Result” field uses a combined code (150) for “25th Gen Hospital or 192nd Gen Hospital,” reflecting an ambiguity in the statistical source file that the 25th’s unit-history record resolves | Morning

Report (S18) / Hospital Admission Card (SGO) / 25th General Hospital unit history (med-dept.com) | | **Jun 17, 1944 | Douve River / Cotentin Peninsula (49.38°N, 1.42°W)** | (*D Company continues without Henry:*) Crossed the Douve River. Passed through 82nd Airborne bridgehead at St. Sauveur-le-Vicomte; advanced to cut the Cotentin Peninsula. 3rd Bn led as advance guard, minor opposition at St. Sauveur. German 77th and 709th Divisions withdrawing. **By 2200, 1st Bn reached G. de Haunville (097909) / ~49.34°N, 1.66°W, severing the La Haye du Puits–Barneville road and completing the isolation of the Cotentin Peninsula. 9th Division credited with greatest advance of the invasion thus far.** Strafed by friendly aircraft. 2 men and 2 vehicles captured by enemy | D Co./47th IR Cherbourg History/47th IR AAR | | **Jun 18, 1944 | Cotentin Peninsula / Port Bail, France | 47th Infantry first unit to reach the sea** — reached Port Bail (068895) / ~49.32°N, 1.70°W and Neuville an Beaumont (138908) / ~49.33°N, 1.61°W, credited with actually cutting the peninsula. Mortars fired almost continuously; knocked out enemy column. Strong pocket of several hundred enemy at Canville (115201) / ~49.60°N, 1.64°W reduced after heavy fighting. **D Company spotted enemy MGs holding up 2nd Bn’s advance and requested permission to fire mortars on them — authorized at 1705.** At 0645, allied planes with friendly markings dive-bombed 2nd Bn, **killing one officer** (friendly fire). BBC announced 9th Division cut the Cherbourg Peninsula; Gen. Eddy ordered the news passed to all troops. **War correspondents at Regimental CP:** Herb Clark (Blue Network), Bill Chaplin (NBC), Larry LeSeur, Cpl Joe Cunningham (*Yank Magazine*). Relieved by 357th Infantry (90th Inf. Div.) at 2100; D Co. marched 7 miles to bivouac near Bricquebec | D Co./47th IR AAR/1st Bn Journal/47th IR Unit Journal | | **Jun 19–22, 1944 | English Channel | THE GREAT STORM.** One of the worst Channel storms in 40 years struck Normandy. Winds Force 6–8. The American Mulberry artificial harbor at Omaha Beach was destroyed, 800+ vessels beached, and **all cross-Channel evacuation and supply halted for three days.** (*Henry had reached the UK reception system by June 19 — first appearing on the 305th Station Hospital morning report that date — so he crossed the Channel just before the storm peaked.*) **George Kysilka was in England by this time as well:** an Admission and Disposition Report places him at the **28th General Hospital** (Kingston Lacy, Dorset, England) on **June 20, 1944** (see next row). Contrary to the family’s long-held assumption, George was therefore **not** stranded in Normandy by the storm — he crossed on essentially Henry’s timeline. The gangrene that cost him his leg developed despite prompt evacuation, reflecting the severity of the mortar wound rather than an evacuation delay | Historical record / 28th Gen Hosp Admission & Disposition Report 20 Jun 1944 / Hospital Admission Card / Morning Report (S18) | | **Jun 20, 1944 | 28th General Hospital, Kingston Lacy, Wimborne, Dorset, England** | (*George Kysilka’s track:*) **George admitted to the 28th General Hospital** — a fixed General Hospital in Dorset, and the first General Hospital in the ETO Communications Zone to receive Normandy battle casualties (from Jun 7, 1944). Listed as **Pfc George Kysilka, ASN 15013985, Co. “D”, 47th Inf, 9th Div;** diagnosis: **battle**

casualty — penetrating mortar wound, lower extremity. This documents George in England by Jun 20, on essentially Henry's evacuation timeline, and **refutes** the earlier assumption that he was stranded in Normandy by the Jun 19–22 storm. (*Data notes: the report's causative agent reads "mortar," vs. "artillery shell fragments" on his SGO Hospital Admission Card — both shell fragments; the form's location reads APO 350, while secondary sources give the 28th Gen Hosp as APO 597.*) | **28th General Hospital Admission & Disposition Report (ETOUSA WD AGO Form 8-122), 20 Jun 1944, p.17** — [photos/nara/medical-records/Kysilka-George_28th-Gen-Hosp-admission_1944-06-20.tif](#) ; 28th General Hospital unit history | | **Jun 19, 1944 | 305th Station Hospital | (Henry's track:) First hospital papers** — Henry appears on the 305th Station Hospital morning report. The 305th was a US Army station hospital serving the Normandy evacuation chain | Morning Report, NARA Cat. 477627076 (S18) | | **Jun 21, 1944 | 305th Station Hospital → US Army Hospital Plant 4150, Cirencester, England (51.71°N, 1.97°W) | Hospital admission, Cirencester.** Henry transferred to **US Army Hospital Plant 4150** at Cirencester — operated by the **192nd General Hospital** since May 20, 1944 (when the 25th General Hospital handed the plant over). Plant 4150 was part of the **15th Hospital Center, Cirencester Park, Gloucestershire** | Morning Report, NARA Cat. 477627076 p.884 (S18); Morning Report, NARA Cat. 477623709 p.940 (S18) | | **Jun 26, 1944 | US Army Hospital Plant 4150, Cirencester, England** | Hospital morning report continues to list Henry — confirming continued treatment at Cirencester | Morning Report, NARA Cat. 477623709 p.970 (S18) | | **Jul 13, 1944 | US Army Hospital Plant 4150, Cirencester, England | Henry released from hospital** — 24 days after the wound (Jun 16 → Jul 13). The 29 "non-effective days" figure on the Hospital Admission Card includes additional days in the evacuation chain on either end | Morning Report, NARA Cat. 481202935 p.928 (S18) | | **Jun 19, 1944 | Mont du Roule / Pinville, France (49.63°N, 1.63°W) | D Company sent to vicinity of Pinville for independent mop-up of bypassed resistance** — unusual tasking for a heavy weapons company. 1st Bn received 16 replacements. March order: A, D, C, B, Hq (D Company second in line). Attacked; contacted enemy at 1000. Advanced to foot of Mont du Roule (enemy strong point near Turlaville). Mortars and MGs fired on enemy from afternoon until dark. Airbursts fired over marching men — few casualties | D Co./47th IR AAR/1st Bn Journal | | **Jun 20–21, 1944 | Mont du Roule, France** | Held up by heavy enemy mortar and small arms fire. Mortars and machine guns firing almost continuously. **D Company: 2 EM killed, 4 wounded.** H Company (Jun 21): 12 EM WIA evacuated, 2 WIA not evacuated, 1 KIA — single bloodiest day recorded | D Co./H Co. | | **Jun 22, 1944 | Mont du Roule / Cherbourg approaches** | Air bombing mission preceded the attack — **some bombs fell in battalion areas causing casualties** (friendly fire). Troops withdrew 1,200 yards for bombing safety, then attacked vigorously at ~1400. 1st Bn crossed the river line at (077178) / ~49.58°N, 1.69°W, encountered mine fields, 4 double-wire aprons, and heavy MG fire at (075180) / ~49.58°N, 1.69°W — a prepared position. Caught in crossfire pattern; dug in at (073183–078176) /

~49.58°N, 1.69°W. D Company captured 55 prisoners. H Company: 1 officer and 10 EM WIA | D Co./H Co./47th IR AAR | | **Jun 23, 1944 | Mont du Roule** | D Company succeeded in taking Mont du Roule; set up defensive positions | D Co. | | **Jun 24, 1944 | Outskirts of Cherbourg** | Captured enemy strong point on outskirts of Cherbourg. 2nd Platoon on hill overlooking city | D Co. | | **Jun 25, 1944 | Cherbourg, France (49.63°N, 1.62°W) | 47th Infantry first to enter the Cherbourg fortress.** Broke into the western side of the city and drove to the beach at ~49.58°N, 1.69°W. 1st Platoon attacked with B Company. Mortars fired ~1,400 rounds into Cherbourg docks. **2nd Bn mortars destroyed 7 Nebelwerfers.** Arsenal area partially cleared but thick-walled and underground installations remained a center of strong resistance. Fierce resistance encountered all the way, but “the spirited drive of the 47th was not to be stopped” | D Co./47th IR AAR | | **Jun 26, 1944 | Cherbourg, France | CHERBOURG FELL.** White flags appeared. Hundreds of prisoners captured. 1st Bn (“B” Company having reverted) entered city at 0800 with C Company leading — fought all day reducing strongpoints and clearing snipers. All organized resistance ceased except the Arsenal | D Co./47th IR AAR | | Jun 27, 1944 | Cherbourg / Cap de la Hague | **Col. Smythe personally delivered ultimatum to German Commandant General Major Sattler at the Arsenal; surrender effected at 0930.** Two German hospitals taken containing 2,600 patients (including 150 American wounded). At 1600, **liberation ceremony at the Place de Napoleon** — elements of 9th, 4th, and 79th Divisions participated. Cleaning out remaining enemy toward Cap de la Hague (~3,000 Germans still resisting). H Company: **2 KIA, 1 officer and 14 EM WIA** (heavy mortar fire at Aculleville) | D Co./H Co./47th IR Cherbourg History/47th IR AAR | | Jun 28, 1944 | Cotentin Peninsula, France | **D Company strength after ~80 replacements: 148 EM & 7 Officers.** (A Co: 149 EM & 4 Off; B Co: 141 EM & 5 Off; C Co: 124 EM & 6 Off.) Col. Vanderhoef and patrol personally captured Lt. Col. Kiel, believed to be commander of all remaining Germans in the boot of the peninsula, along with his staff and second-in-command | 1st Bn Journal | | Jun 29–30, 1944 | Cap de la Hague — Nacqueville / Digulleville / Greville | 1st Bn occupied successive objectives along the NE coast of the Cape. 2nd Bn moved through Nacqueville (mined, few enemy). Heavy resistance initially from underground emplacements and artillery, diminishing by 2400. **Jun 30: Lt. Stewart of D Company reported wounded.** Regiment cleared the last German resistance | D Co./1st Bn Journal/47th IR AAR/Eng/Fr docx | | **Jul 1, 1944 | Cap de la Hague, France | Colonel Keil captured at 0400 by 1st Battalion.** Shortly after, remaining enemy forces surrendered. By 1550, entire 47th Infantry sector reported completely clear of all enemy. Prepared to move to Division assembly area at Bois de Norest (045176) / ~49.58°N, 1.74°W | 47th IR AAR | | Jul 2–7, 1944 | Teurtheville Hague, France (49.58°N, 1.70°W) | Rest camp; movies nightly; replacements received. **2nd and 3rd Battalions later awarded Distinguished Unit Badges** for the Jun 21–26 and Jun 22–30 fighting: 2nd Bn captured 4 fortified positions, 1,100 prisoners, and 25 AA guns while suffering 113 casualties; 3rd Bn killed 314 and captured 2,161 enemy while losing 28 killed and 145 wounded in 9 days | D Co./H Co./47th IR Cherbourg History

| | **Jul 13, 1944** | **Cirencester** → **10th Replacement Depot, England** | **HENRY RELEASED FROM HOSPITAL.** Per **192nd General Hospital Special Orders No. 107** (13 Jul 1944, S25), Henry — found physically qualified for duty — was released from US Army Hospital Plant 4150 and transferred o/a 15 Jul 1944 to the **10th Replacement Depot** (APO 574), the Lichfield reinforcement depot. *(This order also settles the receiving general hospital as the 192nd, not the 25th. Earlier reconstructions placed Henry's return to D Company in early July; the morning-report record contradicts this — see Lichfield/Le Mans/Étampes entries that follow)* | 192nd Gen Hosp SO No. 107 (S25) / Morning Report (S18) / Newspaper | | **Jul 19, 1944** | **Whittington Barracks, Lichfield, Staffordshire, England (52.68°N, 1.79°W)** | **AWOL at 2330 hrs.** Six days after release from hospital, Henry went absent without leave from the **10th Replacement Depot at Lichfield** — headquartered at Whittington Barracks (with a satellite staging camp at the Pheasey Estate), the principal U.S. Army replacement and disciplinary command in the UK (later notorious for the “Lichfield case” treatment-of-prisoners court-martial, 1945). The morning report documents the AWOL with timestamp | Morning Report, NARA Cat. 481125251 p.587 (S18) | | **Jul 22, 1944** | **(Lichfield/replacement depot)** | Assigned to the **10th Replacement Depot** on the morning-report rolls — administratively recorded after the AWOL | Morning Report, NARA Cat. 481125251 p.655 (S18) | | **Jul 25, 1944** | **Lichfield, England** | **Court-martial: convicted of AWOL.** Trial held 6 days after the Jul 19 absence. The Jul 27 morning report (next entry) records the conviction date and the disposition; no separate Jul 25 morning report has been located. (Henry's only known disciplinary record.) | Morning Report, NARA Cat. 481125251 p.794 (S18) (referenced) | | **Jul 27, 1944, 0745 hrs** | **Lichfield, England** | **Released from confinement at 0745; returned to duty.** Two days of post-conviction confinement (Jul 25 → Jul 27) — the entire AWOL-and-conviction episode resolved in 8 days from start to finish. The case was disposed of locally and Henry remained in the replacement system rather than rejoining a combat unit. **Henry retained his PFC rank** — every subsequent morning report (Sep 1944 through discharge Jun 1945) lists him as PFC, and his Honorable Discharge at Fort Dix on Jun 24, 1945 records him as PFC. Reduction in grade was a standard element of any court-martial AWOL conviction at this period (the maximum punishment for a Summary Court-Martial included reduction by one grade); the fact that Henry's rank survived indicates the offense was disposed at the lowest level and treated as a minor infraction. The brief confinement (~2 days) is consistent with a Summary Court-Martial sentence, not a Special or General. He also retained eligibility for the Good Conduct Medal, which requires 3+ years of “exemplary behavior, efficiency, and fidelity” and which he received | Morning Report, NARA Cat. 481125251 p.794 (S18) | | **Jul 3, 1944** | **Cap de la Hague, France** | **1st Bn command change: Major Herman A. Schmidt replaced Lt. Col. Vanderhoef as 1st Bn CO.** Vanderhoef had commanded 1st Bn from at least Jun 14 through the Cherbourg campaign | 1st Bn Journal | | **Jul 9–13, 1944** | **SW of St. Jean de Daye, France (49.20°N, 1.15°W)** | Attacked against strong resistance; slow progress against MG, mortar, direct 88mm, and enemy

tank fire. Tank counterattack pierced left flank. **Facing SS Grenadier groups with modified Mark V tanks.** Jul 11 casualties: **7 killed, 24 wounded.** **Jul 11: Regimental CP hit by accurately placed artillery** — truck, tents, and many valuable records destroyed; **Col. Smythe wounded in the hand but not evacuated.** Jul 12: 1st and 2nd Bns jumped off at 0800; **8 killed, 21 wounded.** 2nd Bn fought into LeHommet against very heavy mortar and AT gun fire; enemy counterattack repulsed. Unusual enemy tank/armor activity observed at (420716) / ~49.16°N, 1.22°W — all Bns ordered into strong defensive positions with mines and roadblocks. H Company: 7 EM WIA on Jul 9; medic KIA and multiple WIA on Jul 13. **Jul 13: Lt. Centurione (D Co.) killed near a crossroads by artillery shell** — he had participated in the Anglo-American exchange program on the Isle of Wight in April 1944. D Company warned about mortar fire near G Company's position at grid (424717) / ~49.16°N, 1.22°W. Jul 13: 2 killed, 9 wounded | D Co./H Co./1st Bn Journal/47th IR AAR | | **Jul 17–20, 1944 | SW of St. Lo, France (49.12°N, 1.08°W)** | Enemy artillery extremely heavy. **Jul 17: 1st Bn suffered 8 KIA and 35 WIA — D Company reported at 1015 that friendly artillery ("Nostril White") was falling short** into their area. H Company: 3 WIA on Jul 17; 10 WIA on Jul 18. **Jul 19:** 1st Bn in reserve; received **105 EM and 4 Officer replacements.** **Jul 20: D Company CO Capt. Jesse F. Niven killed by enemy artillery.** Shrapnel from the same barrage also killed Capt. Minton and Lt. Murray at the Bn CP, and wounded Pvts. Farnsworth, Beer, and Sgt. Cross; 1 B Co man also killed, 3 wounded. Lt. Frederick Scheel took command of D Company. Staff and Company Commanders meeting held at 2345 | D Co./H Co./1st Bn Journal | | **Jul 21, 1944 | SW of St. Lo, France | 6 officers and 5 EM returned from hospital in England.** Five missing A Company men located. (*Henry was NOT among these hospital returnees — morning-report evidence places him at Lichfield, UK on Jul 21, 1944. He had been released from hospital Jul 13 to a replacement depot, gone AWOL from Lichfield Jul 19, and would not return to the 47th Infantry until Oct 29, 1944.*) | 1st Bn Journal/Morning Report, NARA Cat. 481125251 p.587 (S18) | | **Jul 23, 1944 | SW of St. Lo, France | Mass held in Bn area. 102 more replacements + 7 returnees** received. Lt. McLaughlin became acting S-3 (replacing the killed Capt. Minton). Friendly planes bombed and strafed enemy positions | 1st Bn Journal | | **Jul 24, 1944 | St. Lo area, France | Cobra H-hour announced as 1300. Battalions withdrew to bomb-safety line. Attack suspended due to very low ceiling** — all Bns moved forward quickly to re-occupy vacated ground before the enemy could take it. Met small arms, mortar, and heavy artillery fire returning to positions. 4 casualties from enemy artillery | 47th IR AAR/1st Bn Journal | | **Jul 25, 1944 | St. Lo, France (49.12°N, 1.08°W) | OPERATION COBRA.** At 0927 all troops pulled back to bomb-safety line. Light bombers went in first, followed by a full hour of heavy bombers. **Due to a light breeze from the south, haze and target-marking smoke drifted toward American lines, causing bombers to drop some of their load on own units** — casualties in the regiment. "The greatest bombing." Dust and dirt rose hundreds of feet. 1st Bn started moving at 1100, reached the highway by 1400, and pushed south to (394661–398660) / ~49.11°N,

1.25°W by 2245. 3rd Armored and 1st Infantry rushed through the breach. H Company: 2 EM KIA by friendly bombs; 1 WIA by bomb fragments | D Co./H Co./47th IR AAR | | Jul 26–29, 1944 | Cobra advance, south of St. Lo | Rapid advance with daily casualties. **Jul 26:** 14 WIA; 4 KIA, 17 WIA. **Jul 27:** ~4 KIA, 28 WIA. Maj. Bryant promoted to Regt. S-2; Lt. Langland returned as Bn S-2; Lt. Snyder became Bn S-3. **Jul 28: Enemy planes bombed and strafed the area — 31 casualties.** **Jul 29:** Division in Corps reserve, 2.5 miles SE of Marigny. Anti-aircraft shell exploded on shed roof, injuring Pvt. Taylor and AT platoon leader. 1st Bn CP at (397390) / ~49.07°N, 1.21°W (*grid too far from Orglandes anchor for formula conversion; located from “2.5 miles SE of Marigny”*) | 1st Bn Journal | | Jul 31, 1944 | Near Marigny, France | 13 EM + 1 Officer replacements received. Each man received complete change of ODs. **Capt. Balling assigned as company commander.** Bn on 3-hour alert | 1st Bn Journal | | Aug 1–4, 1944 | Breakout south of Marigny | **Aug 1:** Hot showers; inoculations; Bn moved to area between Le Parte au Villain and Legardt. **Aug 2:** 1st Bn passed through 1st Bn, 8th Infantry Regt; advanced on objectives. AP mines reported in trail. 2 KIA, 17 WIA. **Aug 3:** 3rd Bn passed through 1st Bn toward objective. 5 WIA. **Aug 4:** C Co patrol captured 6 prisoners from German 336th Division, 957th Regt; A Co captured 4 more. Advancing toward Fontenermont | 1st Bn Journal | | Aug 5–16, 1944 | Breakout across France | Rapid advance: La Busson, La Guezibiere, St. Pois, Brouaines. D Company riding on tanks, advancing 40–63 miles per day. Continued resistance but enemy line breaking | D Co./H Co. | | Aug 22 – Sep 1, 1944 | Pursuit across France | Motor convoys covering 85+ miles/day: Mortagne, Verneuil, Melun, across the Marne toward Belgium | H Co. |

Belgium and the Siegfried Line (Sep–Dec 1944)

Note on Henry’s track Sep–Oct 1944: While D Company crossed into Belgium, fought through the Siegfried Line, and entered the Hürtgen Forest, Henry was still in the U.S. Army replacement system in France, having been routed there from the UK after his Jul 25 court-martial conviction and Jul 27 release from confinement. The morning-report record traces his path through three replacement depots (the 10th, 19th, and 3rd) — and several subordinate replacement battalions and companies — between Le Mans and Étampes (the 19th Depot near Paris that received hospital returnees) before he was finally returned to the 47th Infantry on Oct 29, 1944. The June 1944 Army policy of automatically returning recovered wounded to their original units (recorded in the morning-report transcript header) likely explains why Henry was eventually routed back to the 47th rather than fed in as a generic replacement to another unit. [S18]

Date	Location	Event	Source
Sep 2, 1944	Crossed into Belgium		H Co.

Date	Location	Event	Source
Sep 11, 1944	Le Mans, France (48.00°N, 0.20°E)	(Henry's track:) On rolls of the 10th Replacement Depot at Le Mans — the principal U.S. Army replacement hub in northwestern France in autumn 1944	Morning Report, NARA Cat. 570547057 p.2998 (S18)
Sep 11, 1944	Le Mans, France	(Henry's track:) Assigned to 467th Replacement Company, 82nd Replacement Battalion (within the 10th Repl Depot structure)	Morning Report, NARA Cat. 569348927 p.675 (S18)
Sep 17, 1944	Le Mans, France	(Henry's track:) Still on rolls of 467th Repl Co, 82nd Repl Bn	Morning Report, NARA Cat. 569348927 p.637 (S18)
Sep 21, 1944	Le Mans, France	(Henry's track:) Listed on 10th Replacement Depot rolls (parent unit)	Morning Report, NARA Cat. 569352763 p.430 (S18)
Sep 21, 1944	Étampes, France (48.43°N, 2.16°E)	(Henry's track:) Transferred to the 19th Replacement Depot at Étampes (~40 km south of Paris). The 19th Depot served primarily as a receiving station for hospital returnees — which is precisely why Henry, a recovered wounded man, was routed there	Morning Report, NARA Cat. 569352763 p.505 (S18); Ruppenthal, <i>Logistical Support of the Armies II</i> , ch. XI
Sep 21, 1944	Étampes, France	(Henry's track:) 19th Repl Depot rolls (continued)	Morning Report, NARA Cat. 569352763 p.579 (S18)
Sep 22, 1944	Étampes, France	(Henry's track:) Assigned to HQ, 19th Replacement Depot	Morning Report, NARA Cat. 569736472 p.1057 (S18)
Oct 4, 1944	(station not given on this roster)	(Henry's track:) Listed, Field 4, 447th Replacement Company, 85th Replacement Battalion — a previously undocumented waypoint between the 19th Replacement Depot (Sep 22) and the 69th Replacement Bn (Oct 21). Identified 2026-07-10 correcting a duplicate/mislabeled frame that had carried two wrong dates ("7 Oct" and "21 Oct") and was miscited as a 19th Replacement Depot record; the roster itself is printed "4 Oct 1944"	Morning Report, NARA microfilm roll 85713825, 1944-10, Roll-0605-00745 (S18)

Date	Location	Event	Source
Oct 21, 1944	Le Mans, France	(Henry's track:) Received by 69th Replacement Battalion , billeted at 351st Replacement Company	Morning Report, NARA Cat. 573042159 p.1212 (S18)
Oct 28, 1944	Le Mans, France	(Henry's track:) Transferred to HQ 92nd Replacement Bn, 3rd Replacement Depot — the depot feeding the 9th Infantry Division on the German border	Morning Report, NARA Cat. 573027648 p.2372 (S18)
Oct 29, 1944	Nord de Guerre Zone, "Vight" 1 mile E (Hürtgen / Roetgen sector, German border)	HENRY RETURNS TO THE 47th INFANTRY. After 135 days away from the regiment (Jun 16 → Oct 29) — through hospital, AWOL, court-martial, and a chain of three replacement depots — Henry rejoins the 47th in the German border zone. By this date the 47th had crossed the Siegfried Line at Roetgen (Sep 14), captured Vicht (Sep 16), and dug into defensive positions around Vicht/Schevenhütte at the edge of the Hürtgen Forest	Morning Report, NARA Cat. 572657393 p.2867 (S18)
Oct 31, 1944	Nord de Guerre Zone, "Vight" 1 mile E	Henry on active duty with the 47th Infantry — back on the regimental rolls. From this point forward Henry serves continuously with D Company through the rest of the war: Hürtgen Forest, Battle of the Bulge (Monschau), Roer crossing, Rhine crossing at Remagen, Ruhr Pocket, contact with the Russians at the Mulde, VE Day	Morning Report, NARA Cat. 572657393 p.2869 (S18)
Sep 6, 1944	Meuse River, Belgium (50.47°N, 4.87°E)	1st Bn attempted to cross the Meuse in row boats at 0200–0300. Engineers guided troops but a large portion of the Bn landed on a small island in the river. Received MG fire on the island and from the opposite bank. D Company crossed in assault boats under heavy fire; re-crossed under mortar fire. Both MG platoon leaders wounded. C Company suffered heavily: ~71 EM and 1 Officer captured on the island. Total 1st Bn casualties: 3 KIA, 10 WIA, 72 missing/captured	D Co./1st Bn Journal
Sep 8–12, 1944	Namur (50.47°N, 4.87°E) → Liege (50.63°N, 5.58°E) → Verviers (50.59°N, 5.86°E), Belgium	Rapid advance through Belgian cities	D Co./H Co.
Sep 13, 1944	Eupen, Belgium (50.63°N, 6.03°E) / German border	Crossed into Germany. Hostile population (former German territory)	D Co.

Date	Location	Event	Source
Sep 14, 1944	Roetgen, Germany (50.63°N, 6.20°E)	Crossed the German border at Roetgen (grid 905285) at 0830. Entered the Siegfried Line. Penetrated well into the outer defenses. Worked through dense forest. Captured 41 prisoners. Noted camouflaged pillboxes (one built to look like a cottage). 1st Bn advanced to Zweifall (grid 955362 / ~50.71°N, 6.25°E), held up by blown bridge. Marched 14 miles. H Company: enemy attacked with tanks at 0730; 1 EM WIA	D Co./H Co./47th IR AAR
Sep 15–16, 1944	Vicht (50.72°N, 6.28°E) / Mausbach / Schevenhutte	Sep 15: Plan to outflank Vicht from east. 3rd Bn engaged 350 enemy attempting to withdraw; 2nd Bn counterattacked by tank and infantry at 0900 — Mark V tank destroyed. 425 prisoners captured including a Colonel and 4 officers. Sep 16: 1st Bn entered Vicht at 1530, captured 100+ prisoners. 2nd Bn reached Krewinkel (grid 980410 / ~50.76°N, 6.27°E), captured ~95 prisoners. 3rd Bn contacted strong force 400 yards short of Schevenhutte (grid 005420 / ~50.76°N, 6.30°E). Regimental CP established at Vicht — remained there through October	D Co./H Co./47th IR AAR
Sep 17–19, 1944	Vicht / Mausbach, Hürtgen Forest	Heavy counterattacks. Sep 17: 2nd Bn attacked by waves of enemy infantry with tanks, mortars, artillery from NE. 3rd Bn “surrounded by enemy, but not seriously.” 1st Bn moved to dominating ground (grid 994418 / ~50.76°N, 6.29°E) between 2nd and 3rd Bns. Sep 18: 3rd Bn counterattacked at 0130 from Gressenich direction; 2nd Bn moved back to reorganize. Sep 19: “Heaviest enemy artillery barrage ever experienced” at 0730. Supply lines stretched to breaking point. D Company: 5 EM wounded by enemy artillery on Sep 17 and 19	D Co./H Co./47th IR AAR
Sep 20–22, 1944	Vicht / Schevenhutte, Hürtgen Forest	Defensive positions; constant enemy artillery, mortar, and tank fire. D Company 81mm mortars fired avg. 200 rounds/day (ammunition rationed). Sep 22: Major counterattack on 3rd Bn at Schevenhutte — preceded by “biggest artillery preparation ever put on against the battalion.” Positions overrun at 0640; restored by 0813. At least 1 full-strength enemy battalion attacked. Enemy casualties: 135+ dead counted in Schevenhutte, 35 wounded evacuated by US medics, 37 captured. 3rd Bn casualties: 7 KIA, 48 WIA (described as “extremely light” given scale of attack)	D Co./H Co./47th IR AAR

Date	Location	Event	Source
Sep 23–30, 1944	Vicht, Hürtgen Forest	Continued defensive positions. Total losses Sep 14–30: 8 EM killed, 28 wounded, 1 officer wounded	D Co.
Oct 1–31, 1944	Hürtgen Forest	Holding positions on edge of Hürtgen Forest. Enemy shelling every few days; daily patrols. Bitter cold, rain, mud, some snow. Mortar ammunition rationed to as few as 16 rounds per week. Losses: 11 EM wounded	D Co.
Nov 2–15, 1944	Near Vicht / Gressenich area	Three-day passes to Verviers or Paris began. Preparations for major attack: forward mortar positions dug, ammunition stockpiled	D Co./H Co.
Nov 16, 1944	Gressenich, Germany (50.77°N, 6.28°E)	Major attack launched. Massive air bombardment at 1100 — “greatest concentration of planes since St. Lo.” D Company mortars fired 1,200+ rounds. Took Gressenich toward nightfall. H Company supported 16th Inf. Regt. and own 1st Bn.	D Co./H Co.
Nov 17, 1944	Gressenich, Germany	Gressenich cleared by 1030 — Co C up west side, Co A center, Co B east. D Company took pillboxes; received multiple-rocket-launcher support for first time	D Co./47th IR AAR
Nov 19–22, 1944	Hill 187 / Hill 167 (~50.80°N, 6.28°E)	Bitter multi-day fight for Hill 187 (grid 985456) — enemy had direct observation on attacking troops crossing open ground. Nov 19: 1st Bn moved to Hill 232 (grid 997443 / ~50.78°N, 6.29°E); Co B assaulted Hill 187 but stopped by intense 88mm flat-trajectory fire. Nov 20: Co B failed again. Nov 21: Co C passed through Co B, reached western edge of Hill 187 but could not advance further — “casualties were severe.” Trees felled by shells made the woods impenetrable; supply and evacuation “one of the utmost hazard.” Casualties so severe that CG 1st Infantry Division ordered the Combat Team to consolidate at 1320; 17 battalions of corps artillery fired 3-minute concentration on Hill 187 at 1615. Ordered to report effective strength. Nov 22: Patrols found Hills 187 and 167 (grid 991462 / ~50.80°N, 6.28°E) unoccupied — enemy had withdrawn overnight. Both hills occupied by platoons	D Co./47th IR AAR

Date	Location	Event	Source
Nov 23, 1944	Eschweiler, Germany (50.82°N, 6.27°E)	Thanksgiving Day. Despite being spread across miles of front, kitchen supplied every man with full dinner: roast turkey, mashed potatoes, dressing, cauliflower, carrots and peas, hot rolls, apple and apricot pie, chocolate cake, and coffee	D Co.
Nov 23–25, 1944	Nothberg / Hucheln (~50.81°N, 6.29°E)	2nd Bn moved through Gressenich and Nothberg (grid 985467) to Hucheln (grid 000474 / ~50.81°N, 6.29°E) — practically every house defended with grenades. Co K occupied fortified factory at Bovenberg after heavy 8" howitzer concentrations. 1st Bn went into regimental reserve	47th IR AAR
Nov 26–28, 1944	Frenzerberg Castle (~50.82°N, 6.31°E)	Assault on fortified Frenzerberg Castle (grid 019489). Nov 26: Co K took SW corner; 2nd Bn reached castle at 2100. 1st Bn reduced strongpoint at (grid 022478 / ~50.81°N, 6.31°E) under smoke screen by 1800. Nov 27: Castle shelled all day — walls too thick to breach. At 1700, enemy commander requested truce to evacuate wounded; PW interrogator tried to effect surrender but failed. 11 seriously wounded evacuated. Nov 28: Co G assaulted the strongpoint at 0900; all buildings cleared by 1030. 1st Bn relieved by 1st Infantry Division elements. H Company: fierce hand-to-hand combat with German paratroopers	D Co./H Co./47th IR AAR
Nov 29 – Dec 6, 1944	Verviers / Elsenborn, Belgium (~50.46°N, 6.20°E)	Pulled out of the line. Rest camp at Verviers; showers, clean clothes, passes. Moved to Camp Elsenborn (grid 902085) in V Corps reserve. Liberal pass policy, re-equipping. Assigned mission to counterattack any enemy penetration in 99th Infantry Division sector — 4 counter-penetration plans prepared	D Co./H Co./47th IR AAR
Dec 7–16, 1944	Langerwehe / Luchem / Duren area, Germany (50.80°N, 6.48°E)	1st Bn to Luchem (grid 038490 / ~50.82°N, 6.33°E), attached to 60th Infantry. Dec 10: 1st Bn seized objective by 0930; counterattacked at 1440, repulsed. Dec 11: 1st Bn reverted to 47th Infantry control. Defensive positions; D Company fired captured German 120mm mortars at Duren. Air force bombed Duren daily	D Co./47th IR AAR

Date	Location	Event	Source
Dec 16–17, 1944	Mutzenich, Germany (~50.56°N, 6.22°E)	BATTLE OF THE BULGE begins. Dec 16 late afternoon: word received of enemy counteroffensive in V and VIII Corps sectors. 1st and 2nd Bns alerted. Dec 17 0500: warning of enemy paratroopers expected SW of Aachen at 0530. 47th CT ordered to move immediately to Eupen, attached to V Corps effective 1145. Motor movement began at 1400; closed into Muzen (grid 925195) just after midnight. Mission: prevent enemy penetration at Monschau-Hofen-Kalterherberg	D Co./H Co./47th IR AAR
Dec 18–19, 1944	Monschau / Hofen, Germany	Dec 18: Enemy attacked at Hofen at 0430 — under control by 0600. 3rd Bn, 395th Infantry attacked by infantry, tanks, and planes, repulsed by 0845. Enemy penetrated to Kalterherberg but original lines restored by 1230. 1st Bn placed one company on high ground west of Monschau (grid 938187 / ~50.55°N, 6.24°E). Dec 19: 47th CT with massive attachments — 38th Cavalry Squadron, 3rd Bn 395th Inf, 196th FA Bn, 99th Recon Troop, 2nd Bn 39th Inf — defended the Monschau-Hofen sector. Company captured paratroopers	D Co./H Co./47th IR AAR
Dec 20, 1944	Monschau, Germany (50.55°N, 6.24°E)	“This has become the Battle of the Bulge and we are holding the northern hinge.”	D Co.
Dec 21–24, 1944	Monschau / Kalterherberg	Defensive positions; improving with concertina and barbed wire. Demolitions prepared for all bridges, culverts, and roads. Active patrolling. Intermittent artillery of all calibres. Enemy buzz bombs flew over nightly. Bitterly cold with blizzards. Dec 24: 2nd Bn moved to high ground E/SE of Kalterherberg	D Co./H Co./47th IR AAR
Dec 25, 1944	Monschau, Germany (50.55°N, 6.24°E)	Christmas Day in the Bulge. 1st Bn defensive positions: Co A held high ground NE of Monschau (grid 943197–945185 / ~50.56°N, 6.24°E to ~50.54°N, 6.24°E); Co B held high ground S and E along main SE road (grid 945184 to road junction 947174 / ~50.54°N, 6.24°E); platoon Co C blocking draw at (grid 945185). 2nd Bn around Kalterherberg (grid 929150 / ~50.52°N, 6.23°E)	D Co./H Co./47th IR AAR

Date	Location	Event	Source
Dec 26–31, 1944	Monschau / Kalterherberg (50.52°N, 6.27°E)	Static defense. Active patrolling. Dec 27: M/Sgt. I.O. Adams killed. Dec 30: 1st Bn patrol ambushed enemy patrol near Co A area — at 1910 encountered German patrol of 6+ men. Dec 31: 1st Bn patrol at 0300 ambushed enemy NE of sector, killing 5, wounding several	D Co./H Co./47th IR AAR

The Final Push — Rhine to the Elbe (Jan–May 1945)

Date	Location	Event	Source
Jan 1–25, 1945	Monschau / Kalterherberg (50.52°N, 6.27°E)	Held defensive positions under heavy long-range artillery (railroad guns). 1st Bn defending E/NE of Monschau (grid 943184 / ~50.55°N, 6.24°E), from (943197) to (946174). Bitterly cold; trench foot evacuations. Built sleds to haul equipment through deep snow. Camouflage snow suits and white-painted vehicles issued. 1st Bn CO: Lt. Col. James D. Allgood (replaced Major Schmidt, Nov 13, 1944)	D Co./H Co./1st Bn Journal
Jan 26, 1945	Monschau area	1st Bn relieved from front-line positions. “Companies A, B, and D assembled in vicinity of (grid 939182 / ~50.55°N, 6.24°E).” D Company confirmed present with 1st Bn at Monschau. Preparations for attack	1st Bn Journal
Jan 29–31, 1945	Hofen / Alzen, Germany	47th Infantry attacked at 0400 on Jan 30. Battalion advanced three miles; took Alzen. Jan 31: 1st Bn cleared pillboxes at (grid 970146 / ~50.51°N, 6.27°E) and (grid 973143 / ~50.51°N, 6.27°E)	D Co./H Co./1st Bn Journal
Feb 2–5, 1945	Rohren / Dreiborn / Wollseifen, Germany (50.52°N, 6.43°E)	Continued advance. Company CP at Hitler’s youth camp, Ordensburg Vogelsang (50.53°N, 6.44°E), on the Urft River. Enemy across the ice-covered river	D Co.
Feb 6, 1945	Urft River	81mm mortars fired 400+ rounds to break ice on river ahead of planned crossing	D Co.
Feb 10–11, 1945	Rolles Boich, Germany	Enemy blew flood gates of dams, making planned river crossing obsolete	D Co.
Feb 18–27, 1945	Mausbach, Germany (50.77°N, 6.32°E)	Preparations to cross the Roer River	D Co.

Date	Location	Event	Source
Feb 28, 1945	Nideggen, Germany (50.69°N, 6.48°E)	Crossed the Roer River on foot over a pontoon bridge	D Co.
Mar 1–7, 1945	Across the Rhineland	Fighting across open plains: Bessenich, Rovenich, Erft River crossing, Hammerzheim, Brenig. Steady advance against varying resistance and heavy artillery	D Co./H Co.
Mar 8, 1945	Remagen, Germany (50.58°N, 7.23°E)	CROSSED THE RHINE at Remagen via the Ludendorf Bridge (seized by 9th Armored Division the day before). Engineers still repairing bridge under fire. Set up defensive positions in Orsberg. Intense enemy air and artillery attacks on the bridge	D Co./H Co.
Mar 9, 1945	Bruckhausen, Germany	B Company beat back a counterattack — mortars largely responsible. Largest rifle company casualties in battalion history	D Co.
Mar 10–18, 1945	Ohlenberg / Notscheid area	Tremendous enemy pressure on the bridgehead as Germans concentrated forces. Heavy fighting. D Company: 8 men wounded; 1 Lt. killed in jeep accident. Ludendorf Bridge collapsed Mar 16 (structural failure) but three pontoon bridges maintained supply	D Co./H Co.
Mar 19–24, 1945	Dinkelbach, Germany	Captured Dinkelbach; mortar and artillery fire slackening	D Co.
Mar 25, 1945	Neustadt, Germany (50.50°N, 7.43°E)	Night attack; only slight resistance. Enemy beginning to break	D Co.
Mar 26–31, 1945	Across central Germany	Rapid advance against little or no opposition: Pouderbach, Sinn (53 miles in one day), Niederwalger, Diedenhausen	D Co.
Apr 1–3, 1945	Berleberg, Germany	MG section encountered hidden enemy; captured 7, wounded 2 in firefight	D Co.
Apr 5, 1945	Niedersfeld, Germany (51.27°N, 8.57°E)	Entering town at 0300, jeeps shelled by enemy — 1 jeep destroyed, 16 men wounded	D Co.
Apr 6–9, 1945	Wiemeringhausen → Assinghausen → Velmede	Continued advance; light opposition. Ruhr Pocket operations	D Co.

Date	Location	Event	Source
Apr 10, 1945	Elpe, Germany (51.25°N, 8.42°E)	Ruhr Pocket sealed. Relieved by 5th Infantry Division	D Co.
Apr 11, 1945	Kletterberg, Germany	Moved 139 miles in one day by own transportation	D Co.
Apr 13–19, 1945	Wolfsberg (51.65°N, 11.03°E) → Harzgerode (51.65°N, 11.13°E) → Ballenstedt (51.72°N, 11.23°E), Germany	Series of attacks through the Harz Mountains; scattered resistance. Taking town after town	D Co./H Co.
Apr 24, 1945	Torten (outskirts of Dessau), Germany (51.82°N, 12.22°E)	Moved 56 miles to the Mulde River — ~45 miles from Berlin. Set up defensive positions awaiting contact with the Russian Army	D Co.
Apr 26, 1945	Mulde River, east bank	Motorized patrol across the Mulde captured a garrison of 250 enemy; patrol then captured by an SS division but released. Returned with 1,500+ prisoners	D Co.
Apr 27–28, 1945	Mulde River area	Daily patrols bringing in 250–300 prisoners each day. Enemy surrendering rather than face the Russians	D Co.
Apr 29, 1945	East of Mulde River	Made contact with the Russian Army approximately 8 miles east of the Mulde River	D Co.
May 1–8, 1945	Torten, Germany	Whole German armies surrendering. Czech uprising; both Russian and American armies driving on Prague. Daily patrols — no enemy anywhere	D Co.
May 9, 1945	Torten, Germany	VE DAY — War in Europe officially ended at 0001. Battalion ceremony. Described as “nothing but a let down”	D Co.

Occupation and Garrison Duty (May–Jul 1945)

Date	Location	Event	Source
May 10–15, 1945	Torten, Germany	Cleaned equipment. Transferred from 1st Army to 9th Army, then to 3rd Army	D Co.

Date	Location	Event	Source
May 16, 1945	Bavaria, Germany	Moved ~250 miles down Hitler's Autobahn into Bavaria; bivouacked ~40 miles from Munich	D Co.
May 17, 1945	Bavaria	First group of men departed under redeployment (going home)	D Co.
May 24, 1945	Hohenwart / Scheyern, Bavaria (48.48°N, 11.45°E)	Moved to new camp; began building barracks, mess halls, outdoor movie theatre. Softball and volleyball organized; daily swimming	D Co./H Co.
Jun 6, 1945	Bavaria	First anniversary of D-Day. Holiday; swimming, baseball, rest	D Co.
Jun 7, 1945	Bavaria	22 men from D Company decorated with Bronze Stars for Heroic Achievement, presented by Maj. Gen. Louis A. Craig, XX Corps (Twentieth Corps, Third Army). Craig formerly commanded the 9th Infantry Division (Aug 1944–May 1945); by June 1945 he commanded XX Corps	D Co.
Jun 13–23, 1945	Bavaria → Furstenfeldbruck (48.18°N, 11.25°E)	Moved to former German Luftwaffe barracks. Assigned to guard several thousand SS troops in stockade. High-point men cycling out for separation to civilian life	D Co.
Jun 24, 1945	Fort Dix, New Jersey (40.02°N, 74.62°W)	HONORABLE DISCHARGE. Henry released from active duty. Home address: 733 Crandall Ave., Youngstown, Ohio	OMPF Certification of Military Service
Jul 7, 1945	Dachau, Germany (48.26°N, 11.43°E)	<i>(D Company continued after Henry's discharge.)</i> Moved to Dachau — barracks previously used by SS troops immediately outside the concentration camp. Guard duty at Dachau and Furstenfeldbruck	D Co.

Key Findings: Henry F. Matola

Full name: Henry F. Matola **Rank:** Private First Class (PFC) **Unit:** D Company, 1st Battalion, 47th Infantry Regiment (“The Raiders”), 9th Infantry Division **Serial/Service Number:** 15013984 **Born:** April 20, 1919, Youngstown, Ohio **Died:** July 29, 2007 (age 88) **Parents:** Anthony R. and Mildred Matola, 733 Crandall Ave., Youngstown, Ohio **Education:** Rayen School,

Youngstown, Ohio **Enlisted:** October 13, 1940, Fort Hayes, Columbus, Ohio **Basic Training:** Fort Bragg, NC, November 1940 **Discharged:** June 24, 1945, Honorable Discharge, Fort Dix, New Jersey **Age at enlistment:** 21 **Address in 2004:** 3595 Waterbury Lane, Powell, OH 43065

Wounding — Confirmed

Date: June 16, 1944 **Location:** Fields northwest of Orglandes, Normandy, France — approximately 49.39°N, 1.45°W (6 days after landing at Utah Beach). Company positions that morning: A Co at grid (253974) / ~49.394°N, 1.449°W, B Co at (249975) / ~49.394°N, 1.454°W, C Co at (252980) / ~49.399°N, 1.450°W; D Co in support nearby. 1st Bn CP at grid (261960) / ~49.381°N, 1.438°W, ~1.5 km SE of the front line. **Wound (as recorded):** Three primary military records, three echelons: the Co. D morning report (16 Jun 1944, S18) records “**shrap jaw and chest,**” classification **SWA**; the 305th Station Hospital A&D report (19–21 Jun, S23) records “**BC Pen W rt shoulder sv**” (penetrating wound, right shoulder, severe; condition “serious,” disposition “evacuated”); the SGO Hospital Admission Card codes it “Wound(s), Penetrating — Neck, generally; Causative Agent: Artillery Shell, Fragments.” Together: one artillery-shell-fragment burst across the right side — jaw, neck, chest, and shoulder. **Evacuation chain:** D Company → Clearing Company, 9th Medical Battalion → Evacuation Hospital, Normandy (1 day per SGO Hospital Admission Card) → Channel crossing Jun 18 → **305th Station Hospital** (Jun 19) → **US Army Hospital Plant 4150 at 15th Hospital Center, Cirencester Park, Gloucestershire, England** (Jun 21 – Jul 13) — operated by the **192nd General Hospital**. The 25th General Hospital had vacated the same plant on May 20, 1944, and was at Fargo Plains/Tidworth in England during Henry’s entire admission window — it did not cross the Channel until late July **Non-effective days:** 29 **Disposition:** Returned to duty, July 1944 **Dropped from company rolls:** June 16, 1944 **Wounded alongside:** PFC George Kysilka, SN 15013985 (same morning report, same date, consecutive service numbers) **George Kysilka hospital record (newly obtained):** Army Hospital Admission Card confirms: admitted Jun 1944, age 23 (note: enlistment record gives birth date Apr 7, 1923, which would make him 21 — discrepancy in admission age). Diagnosis: wound to leg, causative agent artillery shell fragments; secondary diagnosis gangrene, not elsewhere classified. Treatment: removal of foreign bodies from extremity. Battle casualty, in line of duty. Discharged under Section II, AR 615-360 (medical discharge, line of duty). Length of service: 3 years, 9–11 months. **Note:** Hospital card lists discharge date as “Apr 1944” which precedes admission “Jun 1944” — likely a transcription or OCR error. Source: George Kysilka Hospital Admission Card & Army Enlistment Record. **Other casualties same day:** Lt. Glider (D Co.) — survived vehicle attack that afternoon; Lt. Bowles and Pvt. Garrison presumed KIA in same incident. C Co commander injured; Lt. Morgan of B Co injured. Total 1st Bn casualties by 1200: 1 KIA, 20 EM WIA, 2 officers WIA, 2 sick evacuated. **Context:** 1st Battalion was attacking northwest from positions near Orglandes, with enemy

mortar and artillery fire coming from the town itself (~49.392°N, 1.450°W) — just 200-500 meters south of the American front line. D Company was in a support role behind A, B, and C Companies. H Company records describe this as the day they laid “the heaviest concentration of fire ever” by the company, taking Canville by 2000 hours. By day’s end, 1st Bn had advanced through Hauteville Bocage to positions astride the St. Sauveur-Valognes road.

Notification: Henry’s parents were notified of his wounding by a letter from their son’s friend — not through official War Department channels. The newspaper article mentions only the shoulder wound. Every site the family remembered is now documented in a primary military record: **jaw and chest** in the Co. D morning report, **right shoulder** in the 305th Station Hospital A&D report, **neck** in the SGO Hospital Admission Card.

Sources: - Company Morning Report, D Company, 47th Infantry, dated June 18, 1944 (DSC_4277.JPG / Dad and George wounded.jpg) - Newspaper article, Youngstown-area paper (Henry wounded.png) - 309-INF(47)-0.1 EU wounded 1 44 to 12 44.pdf, page 11 (Normandy Campaign WIA roster listing “Matola, Henry F.”)

Recovery and Return

Per the Hospital Admission Card, Henry spent **29 non-effective days** and was treated at the **15th Hospital Center at Cirencester Park, Gloucestershire, England**. The morning-report record [S18] now allows the chain to be reconstructed in detail:

- **Jun 16, 1944** — Wounded near Orglandes / vicinity of Pivauville (Picauville), Normandy
- **Jun 17, 1944** — Evacuation Hospital, Normandy (1 day per SGO Hospital Admission Card)
- **Jun 18, 1944** — Channel crossing (morning report this date lists Henry “Hosp unknown” — consistent with mid-transit)
- **Jun 19, 1944** — On 305th Station Hospital morning report (first hospital papers, UK) — beat the Great Storm (Jun 19–22) into the UK reception system
- **Jun 21, 1944** — Admitted to **US Army Hospital Plant 4150** (15th Hospital Center, Cirencester), operated by the **192nd General Hospital** since May 20, 1944 (when the 25th General Hospital handed the plant over)
- **Jun 26, 1944** — Still at Cirencester
- **Jul 13, 1944** — Released from Plant 4150 to a replacement depot in England
- **Jul 19, 1944, 2330 hrs** — AWOL from the **10th Replacement Depot at Lichfield, Staffordshire**
- **Jul 22, 1944** — Administratively assigned to 10th Repl Depot
- **Jul 25, 1944** — Court-martial: convicted of AWOL

- **Jul 27, 1944, 0745 hrs** — Released from confinement after ~2 days; returned to duty
- **Sep 11 – Oct 28, 1944** — Routed through three replacement depots (and their subordinate battalions/companies) in France: **10th Repl Depot** (Le Mans) → **467th Repl Co / 82nd Repl Bn** (Le Mans) → **19th Repl Depot** (Étampes) → **HQ 19th Repl Depot** → **69th Repl Bn / 351st Repl Co** → **HQ 92nd Repl Bn / 3rd Repl Depot**
- **Oct 29, 1944** — Returned to the 47th Infantry in the Hürtgen / Roetgen sector — **135 days after being wounded, and four months later than the prior reconstruction had assumed**

This means Henry was **not** with D Company for the St. Lô hedgerow fighting, Operation Cobra, the Falaise breakout, the dash across France, or the crossing into Belgium. He rejoined just as the 9th Division was settling into defensive positions at the edge of the Hürtgen Forest. From late October 1944 forward, Henry served continuously with D Company through the **Hürtgen Forest, the Battle of the Bulge (Monschau — “the northern hinge”), the Roer River crossing, the Rhine crossing at Remagen, the Ruhr Pocket, contact with the Russian Army at the Mulde River, and VE Day.**

The **June 1944 Army policy** documented in the morning-report transcript header — that recovered wounded soldiers were automatically returned to their original units rather than reassigned as generic replacements — is the most likely explanation for why Henry, despite his AWOL conviction and months in the replacement system, was ultimately routed back to the 47th Infantry. **Henry confirmed on his OMPF questionnaire (page 13) that his last military organization was “9th Infantry Division, 47th Infantry, Company D”** — independent corroboration that he ended the war in the unit he started it in.

On the AWOL — what the rank evidence tells us. Reduction in grade was standard for any court-martial AWOL conviction in this period (the maximum punishment for a Summary Court-Martial under the 58th Article of War included confinement up to 30 days, forfeiture of two-thirds pay for one month, and reduction by one grade). Henry’s rank survived the conviction: every subsequent morning report from September 1944 through his discharge on June 24, 1945 lists him as PFC; his Honorable Discharge document records him as PFC. He also retained eligibility for the **Good Conduct Medal** (3+ years “exemplary behavior, efficiency, and fidelity”), which he received. The combined evidence — rank preserved, GCM awarded, trial held within 6 days of the absence, and only ~2 days of post-conviction confinement before release at 0745 on Jul 27 — strongly indicates the offense was disposed at the **Summary Court-Martial** level (the lowest of three court-martial tiers) and treated as a minor infraction. Six days out of hospital from a neck wound, Henry was at Lichfield — a depot whose punitive culture would later become infamous in

the 1945 “Lichfield case” treatment-of-prisoners court-martial. The morning-report record establishes the facts of the trial and the release; the rank evidence establishes the severity, or rather its lack of severity.

The **Purple Heart medal** was physically mailed to his mother in Youngstown while Henry was still overseas (per newspaper article).

Awards (confirmed — physical medals in family possession)

- **Purple Heart** — for wounds received June 16, 1944; documented by **General Orders No. 76, HQ 9th Infantry Division, 23 May 1945** (Section VIII, Award of Purple Heart), which name Pfc Henry F Matola, ASN 15013984 (S24) — the order authenticated by Col. William C. Westmoreland, the division’s chief of staff — and by the physical medal mailed to his mother (per newspaper). The medal survives in the family’s possession, its reverse engraved *For Military Merit* with his name, **Henry F. Matola**
- **Combat Infantryman Badge, 1st Award** — for sustained ground combat service as an infantryman (March 1943 El Guettar through May 1945 VE Day)
- **Bronze Star Medal** — awarded retroactively based on CIB, under the 1947 War Department policy granting the Bronze Star to all WWII CIB holders (rationale credited to Gen. George C. Marshall — the CIB recognized the same ground-combat hardships that justified creating the Bronze Star in 1944, per Marshall’s 3 Feb 1944 memo to FDR). The BSM itself was authorized by **Executive Order 9419 (4 Feb 1944, retroactive to 7 Dec 1941)**, announced in **War Department Bulletin No. 3 (10 Feb 1944)** — confirmed by a National Personnel Records Center letter dated 4 June 2007 ([data/nara/henry/bronze star/BSM-Policy-Background.md](#)). Derivative of the CIB, not a separately-cited action; the exact 1947 circular number for the CIB-retroactivity policy itself remains TBD. The physical medal survives in the family’s possession, its reverse engraved with his name
- **American Defense Service Medal** — for active duty service between Sep 8, 1939 and Dec 7, 1941 (Henry enlisted Oct 13, 1940)
- **American Campaign Medal** — for military service in the American Theater of Operations during WWII
- **European-African-Middle Eastern Campaign Medal** — with 1 silver service star and 1 bronze service star, indicating **6 campaign credits** (silver = 5, bronze = 1)
- **World War II Victory Medal** — for service between Dec 7, 1941 and Dec 31, 1946
- **Good Conduct Medal** — for exemplary behavior, efficiency, and fidelity; requires 3+ years of active service (Henry served 4 years, 8 months)

- **Honorable Service Lapel Button WWII** — the “Ruptured Duck,” awarded for honorable discharge

D Company Casualties — Normandy Campaign (Jun–Sep 1944)

Henry’s comrades. Compiled from the D Company casualty list (Doc 2, p.66) and the 1st Battalion casualty roster (Doc 3, pp.100–113). Covers landing in France through 30 September 1944. [S9]

Killed in Action:

Name	Rank	Notes
Naven (Niven), Jesse D. Jr.	Captain	D Co. CO — KIA Jul 20, 1944 by enemy artillery
Perdue, James	2nd Lt	KIA (date unknown)
Centurione, Joseph	2nd Lt	KIA Jul 13, 1944 — killed near crossroads by artillery shell
Torba, Charles A.	S/Sgt	
Christensen, Arne C.	PFC	
Eddy, Charles J.	PFC	
Fribley, Ray W.	PFC	
Richardson, Joseph D.	PFC	
Cawley, Herbert P.	Pvt	
Hawthorne, Chas.	Pvt	
Toler, Frank	Pvt	

Died of Wounds: Friar, Harold I. (Pvt); Rodriguez, Librado (Pvt)

Wounded in Action:

Name	Rank	Notes
Matola, Henry F.	PFC	WIA Jun 16, 1944 — shrapnel to neck/jaw/chest/shoulder
Kysilka (Kysilka), George	PFC	WIA Jun 16, 1944 — shrapnel to right leg; gangrene confirmed by hospital admission card; removal of foreign bodies; medical discharge (Sec II, AR 615-360)
Clark, Carl	PFC	
Cumbe, John	Pvt	

Name	Rank	Notes
De Martino, Alfred	PFC	
Everest, Charles R.	Tec/5	
Exell, James	PFC	
Glider, Joseph	2nd Lt	WIA Jun 16 — Bronze Star for rescuing officer from burning vehicle
Hamilton, Winford	2nd Lt	
Hodgson, Howard M.	PFC	
Leiter, Jack O.	PFC	
Ottinger, Charles D.	S/Sgt	
Stewart, [first name unclear]	PFC	WIA Jun 30
Chojnacki, Arthur J.	Pvt	
Constan, Robert M.	Pvt	
Doyle, Dawson D.	Pvt	

Missing in Action: Cochran, George H. (Pvt); Loyer, Wilbur E. (Pvt)

Note: Serial numbers in the OCR'd casualty lists are misaligned with names due to multi-column OCR garbling. The names and ranks are reliable; serial numbers require manual verification against the original documents.

1st Battalion Command Changes (1944–1945)

Date	Commander	Notes
Through Jun 1944	Lt. Col. Den T. Vanderhoef	Commanded 1st Bn through the Cherbourg campaign
Jul 3, 1944	Major Herman A. Schmidt	Replaced Vanderhoef
Nov 13, 1944	Major James D. Allgood	Replaced Schmidt (hospitalized)
Jan 1945	Lt. Col. James D. Allgood	Promoted; commanded through end of war

9th Division CG change: Maj. Gen. Manton S. Eddy replaced by Maj. Gen. Louis A. Craig on **Aug 19, 1944**. [S9/S14]

47th Infantry regimental command change: Col. George W. Smythe — who commanded the regiment through Normandy, the Siegfried Line, and the Bulge — was transferred on **Mar 13, 1945**; **Lt. Col. Peter O. Ward (O-18574)** assumed command of the 47th Infantry and led it through the Remagen bridgehead and Ruhr Pocket to VE Day. Henry was serving with the regiment at the time of the change. [S21]

Theaters Served

Theater	Dates	Key Engagements
Stateside (Fort Bragg, NC)	Oct 1940 – Oct 1942	Training and unit assignment
North Africa	Nov 1942 – Jul 1943	Operation Torch (Safi), Kasserine Pass, Battle of El Guettar, Sedjanane, Bizerte
Sicily	Aug – Nov 1943	Troina, Cesaro
England	Nov 1943 – Jun 1944	Training; reviewed by Churchill and Eisenhower; recovery from wounds (~Jun–Jul 1944)
France	Jun 1944 (combat); Sep–Oct 1944 (replacement system)	Utah Beach (D+4), near Orglandes (wounded Jun 16); evacuation to England. (<i>Did not participate in Cherbourg, St. Lô hedgerows, or Operation Cobra — was in hospital, then AWOL/court-martial at Lichfield, then routed through 3 replacement depots between Le Mans and Étampes before returning to the 47th</i>)
England (recovery)	Jun 19 – Jul 13, 1944	305th Station Hospital → US Army Hospital Plant 4150, Cirencester (192nd General Hospital, at 15th Hospital Center)
England (replacement system)	Jul 13 – ~Sep 11, 1944	10th Replacement Depot, Lichfield — including AWOL Jul 19, court-martial conviction Jul 25, release from confinement Jul 27
Belgium	(D Co. only — Henry not present)	Meuse River crossing, advance through Namur/Liege/Verviers
Germany	From Oct 29, 1944 – Jul 1945 (Henry rejoined 47th Oct 29)	Hürtgen Forest (defensive — late Oct/Nov 1944 onward), Siegfried Line, Battle of the Bulge (Monschau — “northern hinge”), Roer River crossing, Rhine crossing at Remagen, Ruhr Pocket, contact with Russian Army at the Mulde River, VE Day, occupation duty at Dachau

Notable Events Witnessed

- **Nov 8, 1942** — Operation Torch landing at Safi, Morocco
- **Mar 28, 1943** — Battle of El Guettar begins (9 days of combat)

- **Jun 14, 1943** — King George VI reviewed the 47th Infantry at La Senia Airport, Algeria (the 2nd Battalion was presented as the regiment’s “crack battalion”; whether Henry’s 1st Battalion paraded is not documented)
- **Aug 7–10, 1943** — Sicily campaign fighting at Troina and Cesaro
- **Oct 26, 1943** — Reviewed by General Patton in Sicily
- **Mar 24, 1944** — Reviewed by Prime Minister Churchill and General Eisenhower in England
- **Jun 10, 1944** — Landed at Utah Beach, Normandy (D+4). **Ernie Pyle** spent nine days embedded with the 9th Division during the Cherbourg campaign, writing: “The Ninth is one of our best divisions.” The *Boston Globe* editorialized: “If any unit has earned the right to be called Hitler’s nemesis, it is the U.S. Ninth Division.”
- **Jun 16, 1944** — Wounded by shrapnel near Orglandes
- **Jul 13, 1944** — Released from US Army Hospital Plant 4150, Cirencester
- **Jul 19, 1944** — AWOL from 10th Replacement Depot, Lichfield (convicted Jul 25; released from confinement Jul 27 at 0745)
- **Oct 29, 1944** — **Returned to 47th Infantry** in the German border zone (Hürtgen / Roetgen sector)
- **Late 1944** — Hürtgen Forest defensive positions
- **Dec 20, 1944** — Battle of the Bulge — “holding the northern hinge” at Monschau
- **Mar 8, 1945** — Crossed the Rhine at the Ludendorf Bridge, Remagen
- **Apr 29, 1945** — Made contact with the Russian Army at the Mulde River
- **May 9, 1945** — VE Day
- **Jul 7, 1945** — Moved to guard duty at Dachau concentration camp

Source Registry (GPS Three-Layer Model)

Per GPS Element 2 (Complete Citations) and the Three-Layer evidence framework. Sources are classified as **Original** (first recording at/near event), **Derivative** (copies, transcriptions), or **Authored** (compiled works). Information is **Primary** (from direct witness/participant), **Secondary** (reported, not firsthand), or **Indeterminate** (informant unknown). “Primary” and “Secondary” are used **only** to describe information, never sources.

S1 — D Company Unit Histories (1943–1945)

Field	Value
Citation	“History of Company ‘D’, 47th Infantry,” 1 Jan 1943–31 Dec 1943 (9 pages); 1 Jan 1944–31 Dec 1944 (13 pages); 1 Jan 1945–30 Jun 1945 (14 pages). Record Group 407, Entry NM-3 427, NARA, College Park, MD. Filing: 309-INF(47)10-0.1.
Source type	Original — official unit histories compiled by company officers at or near the time of events
Information	Primary — written by participants/witnesses to the events described
Evidence	Direct for unit movements, engagements, and casualties; Indirect for individual experiences (Henry is not named except on casualty rosters)
Provenance	Photographed by researcher at NARA, College Park, MD, May 2024. OCR’d via Apple Vision framework Apr 2026. Originals are typewritten; OCR confidence 96%+.
Files	309-INF(47)10-0.1 D Company 1 43 to 12 43.pdf , 309-INF(47)10-0.1 D Company 1 44 to 12 44.pdf , 309-INF(47)10-0.1 D Company 1 45 to 12 45.pdf

S2 — H Company Unit Histories (1942–1945)

Field	Value
Citation	“History of Company ‘H’, Forty Seventh Infantry,” 26 Oct 1942–31 May 1944 (29 pages); 1 Jun 1944–10 Jun 1945 (27 pages). RG 407, Entry NM-3 427, NARA. Filing: 309-INF(47)9-0.1.
Source type	Original — official unit histories compiled by company officers (Capt. Ray L. Inzer commanding)
Information	Primary — written by participants
Evidence	Indirect for Henry specifically — H Company was a sister company in the same regiment; both companies moved, trained, and fought on the same dates in the same locations. Used to fill gaps in D Company records, particularly for the Sep 1942–Dec 1942 pre-deployment period.
Files	309-INF(47)9-0.1 H Company 9 42 to 5 44.pdf , 309-INF(47)9-0.1 H Company 6 44 to 6 45.pdf

S3 — Company Morning Report, June 18, 1944

Field	Value
Citation	Morning Report, D Company, 47th Infantry Regiment, dated 18 Jun 1944. Photographed from personal/family collection.
Source type	Original — official daily personnel report filed by unit clerk

Field	Value
Information	Primary — recorded by unit personnel within 2 days of the event
Evidence	Direct — names Henry F. Matola and George Kysilka as wounded, with dates and evacuation status
Condition	OCR confidence 0.36–0.56 (very poor). Requires manual transcription via review tool. Two photos exist: <code>Dad and George wounded.jpg</code> and <code>DSC_4277.jpeg</code> .
Limitations	Hospital listed as “unknown” — Henry had not yet reached a hospital in England when the report was filed

S4 — Newspaper Article, Youngstown Area

Field	Value
Citation	The Youngstown Vindicator, August 12, 1944, page 2, column 2, bottom (identified by the family 2026-07-06 — supersedes the earlier “name/date unknown” note). Clipping photographed from family collection; file <code>data/nara/Henry wounded/Henry wounded.png</code> (present on disk, excluded from git — see Limitations). Independently corroborated via digitized archive, 2026-07-27: the same August 12, 1944 Youngstown Vindicator edition is publicly viewable at Google News Archive — the link lands on the front page of the 14-page edition; the family’s clipping specifically identifies page 2, column 2, bottom. This gives the citation a permanent, independently-checkable public source alongside the family’s own photographed clipping. Directly re-viewed and re-transcribed 2026-07-06 (shared inline by the family in conversation, under a “Saw Service in Africa” subheading, part of a multi-soldier local roundup column — the adjacent, unrelated entry for “Pfc. Charles E. Jones, aged 21...” confirms the column format). Full text: <i>“Pfc. Henry F. Matola, aged 25, was wounded in the shoulder by shrapnel in France on June 16. His parents, Mr. and Mrs. Anthony R. Matola of 733 Crandall Ave., were notified in a letter from their son’s friend. He spent sometime in a hospital in England and is now assigned to a replacement depot. Pfc. Matola joined the armed forces in October, 1940, was trained at Fort Bragg, N.C., and saw service in the African campaign before being sent to England in December, 1943. He attended Rayen School. His mother recently received the Purple Heart medal he was awarded.”</i> — matches the previously-transcribed quotes in this citation exactly; no new facts, but full accuracy now confirmed against the actual clipping rather than a prior secondhand transcription.
Source type	Derivative — newspaper reporting based on information received from Henry’s friend’s letter and possibly War Department notification
Information	Secondary — reporter was not a witness; information came through Henry’s friend and his parents
Evidence	Direct for wounding event (date, location, cause); Direct for biographical facts (parents, address, school, enlistment). Simplified wound description (“shoulder” only vs. medical record’s “neck, generally”).

Field	Value
Limitations	Wound description simplified (mentions only shoulder; omits neck/jaw/chest). Notification came via friend's letter, not official channels — possible delay or inaccuracy in details relayed. File location confirmed 2026-07-06: <code>data/nara/Henry wounded/Henry wounded.png</code> — present on disk, intentionally excluded from git by the existing <code>data/nara/**/*.*.png</code> rule (same raw-scan convention applied to all other NARA photos in this project; the transcription above is the durable record). The Google News Archive link (added 2026-07-27) points to the front page rather than the specific page 2 the article appears on — Google's archive viewer doesn't expose a page-specific URL parameter, so the link identifies the correct issue/edition, not the exact page.

S5 — WIA Roster, Normandy Campaign

Field	Value
Citation	"Normandy Campaign Wounded in Action" roster, 47th Infantry Regiment. RG 407, Entry NM-3 427, NARA. Filing: 309-INF(47)-0.1 EU wounded 1 44 to 12 44.pdf, page 11.
Source type	Original — official military casualty roster compiled by regimental staff
Information	Primary — compiled from unit reports by military personnel
Evidence	Direct — lists "Matola, Henry F." as Wounded in Action during the Normandy Campaign

S6 — Henry Research NARA.docx (Family Research Document)

Field	Value
Citation	"Henry Research NARA.docx," compiled by Larry Matola, [~May 2024]. Personal research document.
Source type	Authored — compiled work citing other sources (military hospital file, NARA records)
Information	Primary for family knowledge (birth, death, SSN); Secondary for military details (citing hospital file and NARA holdings)
Evidence	Direct for biographical facts. Contains quoted medical diagnosis from hospital file: "First Location: Neck, generally; Causative Agent: Artillery Shell, Fragments, Afoot or unspecified."
Limitations	The hospital file itself is not in our possession — we have only the quoted diagnosis. The discharge date (June 24, 1945) and enlistment location (Fort Hayes, Columbus, OH) appear to come from discharge papers or similar documents not in the collection.
Key data	Born Apr 20, 1919. Died Jul 29, 2007. SN 15013984. SSN on file (withheld from publication). Discharged Jun 24, 1945, NJ.

S7 — Henry Military Service.docx (Family Research Document)

Field	Value
Citation	“Henry Military Service.docx,” compiled by Larry Matola, [~May 2023]. Personal research document with chronological summary.
Source type	Authored — compiled work, sources not individually cited
Information	Secondary for military events (compiled from other records); Primary for family knowledge (“127 men landed in N. Africa, 7 made it to the war’s end”)
Evidence	Direct for biographical facts; Indirect for unit-level events (provides a framework but individual source records must be verified)
Limitations	Some dates conflict with unit records (e.g., “1 Aug [1942] Left Ft. Bragg” vs. H Company showing departure Oct 14, 1942). Authored works require verification against original sources.

S8 — 47th IR Regimental Records (NARA)

Field	Value
Citation	Various: 309-INF(47)-0.1 (histories), 309-INF(47)-0.2 (monthly histories, Jan–May 1945), 309-INF(47)-0.3 (operations reports), 309-INF(47)-2.1 (G-2/S-2 reports), 309-INF(47)-2.9 (enemy doc excerpts), 309-INF(47)6-0.3 (surgeon’s notes). RG 407, Entry NM-3 427, NARA.
Source type	Original — official military records compiled at or near the time of events
Information	Primary — written by officers and staff who participated in or directly observed the operations
Evidence	Indirect for Henry specifically (regimental-level records rarely name individual PFCs); Direct for unit movements, engagements, and operational context that D Company participated in

S9 — Operation Overlord Collection (Eisenhower Library)

Field	Value
Citation	47th Infantry Regiment records, Boxes 1301–1303, Operation Overlord collection, Dwight D. Eisenhower Presidential Library, Abilene, KS. Obtained Mar 29, 2024.
Source type	Original — official military records (unit journals, after action reports, battalion journals)
Information	Primary — minute-by-minute logs and reports compiled by participants

Field	Value
Evidence	Direct for Henry — Doc 2, p.66 contains a D Company cumulative casualty list (landing through 30 Sep 1944) that lists “Matola, Henry F.” as WIA. Also Direct for operational context. The Unit Journal (Doc 2) contains timestamped entries often to the minute. The 1st Bn Journal (Doc 3) names D Company officers (Lt. Glider, Lt. Centurione, Lt. Stewart, Capt. Niven), provides D Company strength counts, and records the 1st Bn casualty figures for June 15–16 that include Henry. Doc 3 also contains Normandy campaign KIA/WIA casualty rosters (pages 100–113) with D Company men listed by name and serial number, plus awards citations (pages 121–124).
Files	47th IR Mar 29 2024, AA Reports June–dec 1944.pdf (91p), Matola 47th IR Mar 29, Doc 2.pdf (77p), Matola 47th IR Mar 29, Doc 3.pdf (145p), Matola 47th IR Mar 29, Doc 4.pdf (125p)
Key new details extracted (Apr 2026)	Henry Matola listed by name as WIA on D Company cumulative casualty list (Doc 2, p.66). Normandy (Jun 1944): D Co landed ~24 hrs ahead of rest of 1st Bn on separate ship (Jun 10). Jun 8: D Co tried to board ships, turned away — no landing craft. March order Jun 15: A, B, C, D, Hq. 1st Bn front line at grid (253977)–(247977). Sgt. Graeff’s squad hit by mortar at (251974) — 1 KIA, 5 WIA. 1st Bn total Jun 15–16 casualties: 1 KIA, 20 EM WIA, 2 Off WIA. Lt. Glider (D Co) Bronze Star: rescued officer from burning vehicle Jun 16. Jun 18: D Co spotted enemy MGs, fired mortars on them; war correspondents at Regimental CP (NBC, Blue Network, <i>Yank</i>); BBC announced peninsula cut. Jun 19: D Co sent to Pinville for independent mop-up. Cherbourg campaign (Jun 1944): Jun 20–21: D Co 2 KIA, 4 WIA at Mont du Roule. Jun 22: D Co captured 55 prisoners; friendly bombs caused casualties. Jun 25: D Co mortars fired ~1,400 rounds into Cherbourg docks. Jun 26: Cherbourg fell. Jun 27: Col. Smythe personally delivered ultimatum to German commandant at the Arsenal. Jun 28: Col. Vanderhoef captured Lt. Col. Kiel. D Co strength after ~80 replacements: 148 EM & 7 Off. Jun 29–30: Lt. Stewart of D Co wounded. Breakout and pursuit (Jul–Aug 1944): Jul 9–13: Lt. Centurione (D Co) killed by artillery at crossroads. Jul 17: D Co reported friendly artillery falling short into own positions. Jul 20: Capt. Niven (D Co CO) killed by enemy artillery. Jul 24: Cobra suspended due to low ceiling. Jul 25: Operation Cobra — friendly bombs fell on own positions. Jul 28: Enemy air attack — 31 casualties. Command changes: Vanderhoef replaced by Schmidt (Jul 3), Schmidt by Allgood (Nov 13). Casualty rosters: D Co KIA: Capt. Niven, 2nd Lt Perdue, 2nd Lt Centurione + 8 enlisted. D Co WIA: 14 names including Matola and Kysilka. Belgium and Siegfried Line (Sep–Dec 1944): Sep 6: Meuse River crossing — C Co captured on island (~72 men). Sep 14: Entered Siegfried Line at Roetgen, 41 prisoners. Sep 15–16: Vicht captured, 425 prisoners. Sep 19: “Heaviest enemy artillery barrage ever experienced.” Sep 22: Major counterattack on Schevenhutte — 135+ enemy dead. Nov 16: Gressenich attack — D Co mortars fired 1,200+ rounds. Nov 19–22: Hill 187 multi-day fight — 17 battalions corps artillery called in. Nov 26–28: Frenzerberg Castle assault — walls too thick to breach, hand-to-hand with paratroopers. Nov 23: Thanksgiving dinner delivered to every man at the front. Dec 16–17: Battle of the Bulge begins — 47th CT rushed to Monschau. Dec 20: “This has become the Battle of the Bulge and we are holding the northern hinge.” Dec 25: Christmas Day in foxholes. Final push (Jan–May 1945): Jan 26: D Co confirmed at Monschau. Jan 30: 47th attacked, cleared pillboxes. Mar 8: Crossed Rhine at Remagen. Apr 26: Patrol captured 250 enemy, then captured by SS division, released, returned with 1,500+ prisoners. Apr 29: Contact with Russian Army.

S10 — 47th IR Cherbourg History Booklet

Field	Value
Citation	“History, Forty-Seventh Infantry Regiment,” [published ~1944–1945, likely by unit]. 16 pages, illustrated. File: History_of_the_47th_Infantry_Regiment_Cherbourg-compressed.pdf .
Source type	Authored — published regimental history, compiled from operational records and firsthand accounts
Information	Primary (written by/for participants) mixed with Secondary (includes press clippings: Ernie Pyle, YANK magazine, Boston Globe)
Evidence	Indirect for Henry; Direct for 47th IR / 9th Division operations and context. Contains Distinguished Unit Badge citations (General Orders No. 20 and No. 36), which are Original sources embedded within the authored work.

S12 — OMPF Mini Reconstruction File (NPRC)

Field	Value
Citation	“Matola Henry WWII OMPF Mini Reconstruction File.pdf,” 201 pages. Obtained from Twisted Twigs genealogy service, Nov 2024. Original records: National Personnel Records Center (NPRC), St. Louis, MO.
Source type	Original (compilation of original records) — contains: Hospital Admission Card (Office of the Surgeon General), Certification of Military Service (NA Form 13038), monthly company rosters, pay rolls, and copies of unit histories
Information	Primary — hospital card data from point of treatment; rosters compiled by company officers; certification from official records
Evidence	Direct for enlistment date (Oct 13, 1940), hospital treatment (25th Gen Hosp), wound diagnosis, non-effective days (29), return to duty (Jul 1944), discharge date, consecutive service numbers (Matola 15013984, Kysilka 15013985)

Field	Value
Provenance	Henry's original service record was destroyed in the 1973 NPRC fire . This file is a reconstruction from alternate sources including the Hospital Admission Card data files (1942–1945), created by the Office of the Surgeon General, made available to NPRC by the National Research Council in 1988. The hospital file was “originally compiled for statistical purposes; therefore, name identification does not exist and sampling techniques were used.” Veterans identified by service number. Provenance correction (2026-07-06) : the 13-page version actually held in this repo (<code>data/Matola Henry WWII OMPF Mini Reconstruction File (dragged) .pdf</code>) is Henry's own 2003–04 personal correspondence with NPRC (NPRC Service Request #1-86647701), not a third-party genealogy-service compilation — it includes his handwritten, signed “Questionnaire About Military Service” (NA Form 13075, 2-5-04) and NPRC's Jun 23, 2004 reply confirming his separation document could not be found/was likely destroyed in the fire. The larger 201-page “Twisted Twigs” file this citation describes is now also in this repo (<code>data/nara/OMPF file/Matola Henry WWII OMPF Mini Reconstruction File.pdf</code> , supplied 2026-07-06) and has been extracted to Markdown (<code>data/record_cards/Matola Henry WWII OMPF Mini Reconstruction File.md</code> , via the shared toolkit's <code>doc2md</code> tool) and full-text searched. Confirms the pages 14–86/87–201 breakdown below: rosters run 1940–Oct 1943 only (no 1944 coverage), and the 1944 unit-history section never names Henry individually. No content beyond what's already reflected in this timeline.
Key data	Enlisted Oct 13, 1940. SN 15013984. Hospital: 25th Gen Hosp (or 192nd). Wound: penetrating, neck. 29 non-effective days. Returned to duty Jul 1944. Discharged Jun 24, 1945, Fort Dix, NJ. Mother's first name: Mildred.
Pages 14–86	Monthly rosters and pay rolls for D Company, 47th Infantry, Oct 1940–1943. Confirm Henry on every roster. George Kysilka (SN 15013985) appears on the same rosters, confirming they served together from enlistment through the entire war.
Pages 87–201	Copies of 47th IR unit histories and S-2/S-3 journals already in our collection from NARA.

S11 — Family Knowledge (Oral History)

Field	Value
Citation	Oral family history, communicated by Larry Matola (daughter of Henry F. Matola), Apr 2026.
Source type	N/A (oral testimony, not a document)
Information	Secondary — transmitted family knowledge, not firsthand
Evidence	Indirect — provides leads and context requiring verification against documentary sources

Field	Value
Items from family knowledge	Henry and George Kysilka enlisted together (consecutive service numbers); George lost his leg to gangrene; a storm delayed evacuation; Henry returned to his unit ~Jul 1944; Henry had a Bronze Star and Purple Heart
Limitations	Oral history subject to transmission errors over 80+ years. Must be verified against documentary sources where possible.

S13 — 47th IR S-3 Journal, Sicily (Aug 1943)

Field	Value
Citation	S-3 Journal, 47th Infantry Regiment, August 1943. Record Group 407, Entry NM-3 427, NARA, College Park, MD. Filing: 309-INF(47)-0.3.
Source type	Original — official S-3 (Operations) journal compiled by regimental staff during the Sicily Campaign
Information	Primary — timestamped entries recorded by operations officers at or near the time of events
Evidence	Indirect for Henry (regimental-level records; individual PFCs not named); Direct for 1st Battalion and D Company tactical movements, engagements, and operational context during the drive from Troina to Cesaro (Aug 7–14, 1943)
Files	309-INF(47)-0.3 Aug 43.pdf (12 pages, 5,138 words). Note: Italy.pdf in OCR output is a confirmed duplicate of this file (identical page count and word count).
Key details extracted (Apr 2026)	1st Bn attack on Hill 1209 (Aug 8–9); D Co and B Co assault on Cesaro (Aug 13–14); 1st Bn led column into Randazzo (Aug 14); grid coordinates converted to lat/long using conformal affine transformation (Sicily grid rotated ~49° from true north). Anchor points: Troina (540,110) and Randazzo (798,228).

S14 — 47th IR After Action Report, Normandy (Jun–Aug 1944)

Field	Value
Citation	“Action Against Enemy, Reports after / After Action Report,” Headquarters, 47th Infantry Regiment, APO #9. Report 1: 13 June–1 July 1944; Report 2: 1 July–31 August 1944. NARA Dad Army/AAR folder.
Source type	Original — official regimental AAR submitted to the Adjutant General per AR 345-105
Information	Primary — compiled by regimental staff from operational records and unit reports
Evidence	Indirect for Henry (regimental-level; no individual PFCs named); Direct for regiment and battalion operations, including 1st Bn movements, grid positions, and command actions

Field	Value
Files	25 JPEG photos (IMG_1122–IMG_1146) in AAR subfolder. OCR'd Apr 2026.
Key details extracted (Apr 2026)	1st Bn severed La Haye du Puits–Barneville road Jun 17; 47th first to reach the sea (Port Bail) Jun 18; friendly bombing hit own units Jun 22; 7 Nebelwerfers destroyed Jun 25; Col. Smythe delivered personal ultimatum to Gen. Sattler for Arsenal surrender Jun 27; Col. Keil captured by 1st Bn Jul 1; Regimental CP hit and Col. Smythe wounded Jul 11; Cobra friendly bombing detail Jul 25

S15 — “Henry in Englan and France” (Research Document)

Field	Value
Citation	“Henry in Englan and France.docx,” compiled by Larry Matola, [undated]. Personal research document in NARA Dad Army/England and France/ folder.
Source type	Authored — compiled day-by-day log, likely transcribed from D Company or unit records
Information	Primary where it reflects original records; Secondary where compiled
Evidence	Direct for specific dates, locations, and movements from Nov 10, 1943 through Jun 30, 1944. Provides detail on the May 1–7 marshalling area rehearsal not found in other sources
Limitations	States landing was “off Omaha Beach” — all other sources confirm Utah Beach for 9th Division. Likely a transcription error.
Key data	May 1–7 dress rehearsal to marshalling area; specific town names for England billeting (Tichborne, Herriard, Preston Candover) and Cap de la Hague cleanup (Nacqueville, Digulleville, Greville)

S16 — Henry F. Matola Personal Photographs (1940–1942)

Field	Value
Citation	Henry F. Matola personal photograph collection, 95 photographs, Fort Bragg, NC, circa 1940–1942. Scanned from original prints, 2026. Catalog: photos/catalog.json.
Source type	Original — photographs taken at the time of events by participant
Information	Primary — photographer was present at and participated in the events and conditions depicted
Evidence	Direct for location (Fort Bragg, NC — buildings, terrain, unit markings), equipment (M1917A1 MGs, M3 half-tracks, H-D motorcycles, M1903 Springfields), companions (Henry confirmed B1-01; George Kysilka confirmed B2-59), and housing conditions (pyramid tents vs. permanent barracks). Indirect for dates — no date stamps; dates estimated from housing type (tent camp = initial training, barracks = post-basic), equipment (M3 half-tracks delivered 1941+), and seasonal markers (snow photos)

Field	Value
Batches	Batch 1 (B1-01 through B1-30): Pyramid tent camp, late 1940 – early 1941. Batch 2 (B2-01 through B2-64 + 1 colorized): Permanent barracks area, motor pool, athletic field, 1941–early 1942
Key photos	B1-01 (Henry confirmed), B2-07/o8 (Henry with M1917A1 MG – D Co heavy weapons), B2-10 (regimental trucks with “47” markings), B2-47 (9th Division Octofoil + company guidon on building), B2-59 (George Kysilka Class A portrait)

S17 — 47th Infantry Regiment History, Jan–Dec 1943 (NARA)

Field	Value
Citation	“History of the Forty-Seventh Infantry Regiment, January 1943 – December 1943.” Record Group 407, Entry NM-3 427, NARA, College Park, MD. Filing: 309-INF(47)-o.1 AFRICA1 through AFRICA4. OCR’d files in data/ocr_output/.
Source type	Original — official regimental history written during or shortly after events
Information	Primary — compiled by regimental staff from operational records, journals, and after-action reports
Evidence	Direct for unit movements, battles, casualties, command changes, and organizational details. Provides the most detailed narrative of the 47th Infantry’s North Africa and Tunisia campaigns including El Guettar, Sedjanane, and Bizerte
Key content	Unit origin/cadre composition, Spanish Morocco border patrols, President Roosevelt’s visit to Port Lyautey, Battle of El Guettar (detailed hour-by-hour account), Company E destruction and reconstitution, H Company Silver Star awards and casualty roster, Medical Detachment casualties, Sedjanane/Bizerte operations, officer assignments

S18 — Morning Reports, Henry F. Matola (Oct 1943 – Oct 1944) (NARA)

Field	Value
Citation	Daily Morning Reports referencing Henry F. Matola (SN 15013984), 26 entries dated October 13, 1943 – October 31, 1944. Filed in NARA Record Group 407 / 64 (Adjutant General’s Office, WWII operations records). Catalog IDs include 454439085 (Sicily, Oct 1943), 464593435 (Tichborne, Feb 1944), 478540412 (Normandy, Jun 1944), 477627076 / 477623709 / 481202935 (hospital chain, Jun–Jul 1944), 481125251 (Lichfield, Jul 1944), 569348927 / 569352763 / 569736472 / 570547057 / 573027648 / 573034133 / 573042159 (replacement-depot chain, Sep–Oct 1944), 572657393 (return to 47th, Oct 1944). Compiled CSV in data/morning_reports_1943_1944.csv
Source type	Original — daily company/depot morning reports filed contemporaneously with events

Field	Value
Information	Primary — entries written by the unit’s first sergeant or designated NCO at or within hours of the events recorded; signed and submitted daily under AR 345-400
Evidence	Direct for Henry’s individual location, unit assignment, and status on each dated entry — including reassignments, furloughs, hospital admissions and releases, AWOL and disciplinary status, and movement through the replacement system. Provides primary-information evidence on twelve dates between Jul 13 and Oct 31, 1944 that establish his return to the 47th Infantry on Oct 29, 1944 (correcting the prior “~July 1944” reconstruction)
Provenance	Located via NARA Catalog (catalog.archives.gov). Each entry has a deep link to the digitized morning-report image. CSV compiled by family researcher; stored at <code>data/morning_reports_1943_1944.csv</code>
Key findings	(1) Sicily reassignments Oct 13/18 1943 — Henry was on detached duty (QM and HQ 7th Army) before being reassigned back to the 47th. (2) Furlough Feb 4–14 1944 from Tichborne. (3) Wounded “vicinity of Pivauville” Jun 16 1944. (4) Hospital chain: 305th Sta Hosp Jun 19 → US Army Hospital Plant 4150, Cirencester, Jun 21 – Jul 13. (5) AWOL from 10th Repl Depot, Lichfield, Jul 19 1944, 2330 hrs; court-martial conviction Jul 25; released from confinement Jul 27 at 0745, returned to duty. (6) Three-depot replacement chain Sep–Oct 1944 (Le Mans; 19th Depot at Étampes). (7) Returned to 47th Infantry Oct 29, 1944 , German border zone. (8) Transcript header note: June 1944 Army policy to automatically return wounded to original units
Note on family memory reconciliation	The newspaper account (“returned to a replacement depot”) and family memory (“returned to his unit approximately July 1944”) together appear to have conflated the Jul 13 hospital release with return to combat unit . The morning-report record establishes that hospital release and return to combat were separated by ~16 weeks

S19 — 47th IR S-3 Journal, North Africa / Tunisia (Apr–May 1943) (NARA)

Field	Value
Citation	S-3 Journal, 47th Infantry Regiment, 13 April – 10 May 1943 (two consecutive journals: 13 Apr–4 May and 4 May–10 May). Record Group 407, Entry NM-3 427, NARA, College Park, MD. Filing: 309-INF(47)-3.2, Box 6498. Declassified NND735017. Captured NARA 2026 trip; OCR digest at <code>data/nara/Box6498/309-INF(47)-3.2_S-3-North-Africa-Apr-May-1943.md</code> .
Source type	Original — official S-3 (Operations) journal compiled by regimental staff during the final Tunisia offensive
Information	Primary — timestamped entries recorded by operations officers at or near the time of events
Evidence	Indirect for Henry (regimental-level records; individual PFCs not named); Direct for 1st Battalion and D Company tactical movements and operational context in the Sedjanane–Bizerte drive (Apr 13–May 10, 1943)

Field	Value
Key details extracted (2026)	Defensive/patrol fighting through the Bald/Green/Sugarloaf hill mass east of Sedjanane (mule resupply; artillery identification-smoke schedule); final drive into Bizerte (1st Bn light advance May 6; Cannon Co. destroying enemy guns; German demolitions/mines in the city; Gen. Eddy forward at CP May 7); Gen. Harmon's surrender conference with German officers between Tunis and Bizerte, May 9 ; 47th relieved from alert May 10. Folder also held 9th Inf Div Training Memorandum No. 14 (16 Apr 43, Tunisia lessons-learned) and a misfiled typed Co. H roster page (Jan 1941).

S20 — “RAIDERS”: Story of the 47th Infantry Regiment (printed regimental history) (NARA)

Field	Value
Citation	<i>RAIDERS</i> — illustrated regimental history of the 47th Infantry Regiment, 9th Infantry Division (printed yearbook; content spans activation Aug 1940 through the Cherbourg Peninsula, late June 1944). Record Group 407, Entry NM3 427, NARA, College Park, MD. Filing: 309-INF(47)-0.1, Box 6490. Declassified NND735017. Captured NARA 2026 trip; OCR digest at <code>data/nara/Box6490/309-INF(47)-0.1_Story-of-the-Raiders.md</code> .
Source type	Original / Authored — official unit publication compiled by regimental personnel from records and firsthand experience
Information	Primary for events its compilers witnessed; Secondary where it narrates earlier or higher-level actions
Evidence	Indirect for Henry (no individual privates named); Direct for the regiment's organization, command lineage, training, and movements — the only narrative source for the 1940–1942 stateside period (Tent City, barracks move 3 Jan 1941, Carolina Maneuvers, Pearl Harbor, the NC vital-points defense mission, and 1942 amphibious training)
Key content	Activation and Fort Bragg founding (cadres from the 9th and 23rd Inf; first recruit Pvt. Frank L. Hicks, 20 Aug 1940; 70 officers/619 men by 30 Sept 40); command lineage (Ringler → Ambrose → Patch → Randle → Gibson → Randle); Carolina Maneuvers (Rock Hill/Lancaster, S.C.); amphibious training (McFayden's Pond, Solomon's Island, New River); embarkation sequence (POE orders 7 Oct 42; 1st Bn embarked 17 Oct; sailed 19 Oct); the richest Safi landing account (destroyer run into the harbor at 0430; beach/wave times 0700–0725); the Casablanca → Port Lyautey march; and narrative chapters on El Guettar, Bizerte, Sicily, England, and Normandy/Cherbourg. Also contains two “Killed in Action” honor rolls (Africa, Sicily) and a handwritten “African Diary” (Apr–May 43), neither fully transcribed (flagged for an optional zoom pass).

S21 — 47th IR After-Action Report Series, European Campaign (Jun 1944 – Mar 1945) (NARA)

Field	Value
Citation	“Report of Operations / Action Against Enemy — After Action Reports,” Headquarters 47th Infantry Regiment, APO #9 — the regiment’s monthly Reports of Operations for the European campaign. Record Group 407, Entry NM3 427, NARA, College Park, MD. Filing: 309-INF(47)-0.3, Box 6492. Declassified NND735017. Captured NARA 2026 trip (79 images, IMG_4096 – IMG_4174); OCR digest at data/nara/Box6492/309-INF(47)-0.3_After-Action-Reports-EU-1944-1945.md .
Source type	Original — official regimental After-Action Reports submitted to the Adjutant General per AR 345-105
Information	Primary — compiled by regimental staff from operational records and unit reports
Evidence	Indirect for Henry (regimental-level; no individual PFCs named); Direct for regiment and battalion operations, command rosters, and casualty/decoration annexes
Relationship to S14	The Jun–Jul 1944 report here is the same document mined as S14 (the 2024 25-image Jun–Jul capture); the Sep–Dec 1944 detail matches what the timeline already cites as “47th IR AAR.” S21 is the broader 2026 capture of the same AAR series, extending it through Mar 1945 .
Key details extracted (2026)	Reports of Operations for 13 Jun–1 Jul 1944 (Normandy/Cherbourg), 25–31 Oct 1944 (Vicht sector — the period Henry rejoined the regiment), 1–30 Nov 1944 (Gressenich, Hill 187/167, Frenzerberg), and 1–31 Dec 1944 (Bulge, Monschau “northern hinge”); company KIA/WIA/MIA loss annexes (Nov 1944, Mar 1945); a decorations annex of individual heroism citations (16 Jun 1944 – 30 Jan 1945); and the Mar 1945 commanding-officer roster — which records the regimental command change of 13 Mar 1945 (Col. George W. Smythe transferred; Lt. Col. Peter O. Ward assumed command) and corroborates Lt. Col. James D. Allgood as 1st Bn CO.

S22 — History of the 47th Infantry, 1 Aug 1940 – 31 Dec 1942 (NARA)

Field	Value
Citation	“History of the 47th Infantry, August 1, 1940 to December 31, 1942.” Record Group 407, Entry NM3 427, NARA, College Park, MD. Filing: 309-INF(47)-0.1, Box 6490. Declassified NND735017 (classification cancelled 10 Oct 1946). Captured NARA 2026 trip (in the 181-image folder IMG_3860 – IMG_4041); OCR digest at data/nara/Box6490/309-INF(47)-0.1_History-47th-Infantry-1940-1943.md .
Source type	Original — the formal typed regimental history, the companion volume that precedes S17 (1943)

Field	Value
Information	Primary — compiled by regimental staff from operational records
Evidence	Indirect for Henry (no individual privates named); Direct for the regiment's founding, training, and the Operation Torch / Safi landing — including Company D's specific landing (Blue Beach, 0705, 8 Nov 1942) under the 1st Battalion Landing Team (Maj. Frederick C. Feil)
Relationship to S20 / S17	A second, independent narrative of the 1940–42 period alongside the printed <i>RAIDERS</i> yearbook (S20), corroborating the founding story and amphibious-training arc; it is the direct prequel to S17 (which opens 1 Jan 1943). Captured in the same Box 6490 folder as the 2026 re-shoots of S17 (1943 history) and S21 (Oct–Nov 1944 AAR).
Key details extracted (2026)	Reactivation at Fort Bragg 1 Aug 1940; Safi assault timeline (Sub-Task Force Blackstone; <i>Bernadou/Cole</i> harbor run at 0430 guided by a submarine-landed infra-red lamp party; <i>New York</i> silencing the Pt. de la Tour coast battery; 1st Bn beach/wave times incl. D Co. Blue Beach 0705 under artillery fire); Safi battle casualty report; the 238-mile march to Port Lyautey (arrived 19 Dec 1942).

S23 — 305th Station Hospital Admission & Disposition Reports, 19–21 Jun 1944 (NARA)

Field	Value
Citation	Admission & Disposition Reports (WD MD Dept form), 305th Station Hospital, APO 875, dated 19 June 1944 and 21 June 1944. NARA hospital-admission/morning-report microfilm (roll 85713825, 1944-06; frames Roll-0422-00852, Roll-0422-00884, and Roll-0421-00940). Scans filed at data/nara/henry/ .
Source type	Original — hospital admission & disposition register, filed contemporaneously by the receiving station hospital
Information	Primary — recorded by hospital personnel at admission
Evidence	Direct — names Pfc Henry F Matola, SN 15013984, Co. D 47 Inf , as a battle casualty: Wounded , admitted 19 June 1944 , condition “S” (Serious) , disposition “Evac,” brief diagnosis “BC Pen W rt shoulder sv” (penetrating wound, right shoulder, severe)
Key finding	The first primary record of the right-shoulder wound — upgrades “shoulder” from PROBABLE (newspaper/family only) to PROVED (see Assertion 3). Together with S18 (jaw/chest) and the SGO Admission Card (neck), documents a single shell-fragment burst across the right side. Also fixes the receiving hospital in the evacuation chain: 305th Station Hospital → US Army Hospital Plant 4150.

S24 — Purple Heart General Order, 9th Infantry Division (NARA)

Field	Value
Citation	General Orders No. 76, Headquarters Ninth Infantry Division, APO #9, 23 May 1945 , section “ VIII — Award of Purple Heart ” (under AR 600-45, 22 Sept 1943), naming Pfc Henry F Matola, ASN 15013984, INF , for wounds received in action in France; date of wound listed as 15 June 1944 ; entered military service from Ohio. Issued <i>by command of Brigadier General Jesse Ladd</i> and authenticated by Colonel William C. Westmoreland, Chief of Staff (the future Vietnam commander and Army Chief of Staff, then the 9th Division’s C/S). Declassified per E.O. 10501, 1 Jun 2023. NARA catalog set 333187305, frames ..._0731_0152 through ..._0731_0158 (the complete 7-page order; Henry on page 5 , frame ..._0731_0156). Scans: data/nara/purple heart/ .
Source type	Original — official divisional general order awarding the decoration (“ORIGINAL ORDER” stamped)
Information	Primary
Evidence	Direct — documentary record of Henry’s Purple Heart (previously attested only by the family’s physical medal and the newspaper). Henry appears only in Section VIII (Purple Heart); he is not in the order’s Silver Star or Bronze Star heroism sections (consistent with his Bronze Star being the later 1947 CIB-derivative, not a heroism award). Note: the order’s “date of wound 15 June 1944” differs by one day from the 16 June casualty/morning-report record (S18); the contemporaneous morning report is preferred for the wounding date, and the one-day variance is treated as a clerical artifact of the award order (published ~11 months after the wounding).

S25 — 192nd General Hospital Special Orders No. 107, 13 Jul 1944 (NARA)

Field	Value
Citation	Special Orders No. 107, Headquarters 192nd General Hospital (operating US Army Hospital Plant 4150), APO 63, dated 13 July 1944 — releases named enlisted men found physically qualified for duty and transfers them o/a 15 July 1944 to the 10th Replacement Depot (APO 574); Pfc Henry F Matola, 15013984 , named. NARA microfilm roll 85713825, 1944-07, frame Roll-0680-00928. Scan at data/nara/henry/ .
Source type	Original — hospital special order
Information	Primary
Evidence	Direct — names Henry; primary confirmation that (a) he was treated and released by the 192nd General Hospital (definitively settling the 25th-vs-192nd Gen Hosp question) and (b) his first stop in the replacement system was the 10th Replacement Depot (Lichfield) — from which he went AWOL on 19 July (S18).

S26 — D Company Daily Morning Reports, 1–17 June 1944 (NARA)

Field	Value
Citation	Company Morning Reports, Co. “D”, 47th Infantry Regiment, daily for the period ending 2400, 1 June 1944 through 17 June 1944 (17 consecutive daily reports, most 2 pages — front roster/duty page + back narrative/ration page — June 16 ran to 3 pages given the casualty roster). NARA microfilm roll 85713825, 1944-06, frames Roll-0657-02592 through Roll-0657-02626. Supplied by the family 2026-07-09; scans at data/nara/d day version 2/47th d June 1 to 17/ .
Source type	Original — the company’s own contemporaneous daily administrative record
Information	Primary — prepared and signed daily by the company’s Assistant Personnel Adjutant (1st Lt. Robert E. Anderson, later Capt. Dalton L. Nordyke)
Evidence	Direct for D Company’s day-by-day station and movement, 1–17 June 1944. Does not name Henry individually on any day 1–15 June (his rows read “No Change” throughout, alongside routine entries for other soldiers — sick call, promotions, records corrections). First individual entry naming him is 16 June (wounding, already established as S18).
Day-by-day station log	1–5 Jun: Alresford, Hants, England, “usual garrison duties,” strength steady ~144 present for duty. 6 Jun: station “MARSHALLING AREA” — “Left Alresford Hats England Approx 1700. Proceeded to marshalling area Arrived approx 0130 7 June 44.” 7 Jun: marshalling area, “usual camp duties.” 8 Jun: station “ABOARD LCT #16” — “Left Marshalling area and boarded LCT at about 1600.” 9 Jun: aboard LCT #16, “No Change,” “usual ship duties.” 10 Jun: aboard LCT #16 (as of report cutoff), “No Change.” 11 Jun: station “St Mere Eglise, France” — “Disembarked about 2100 10 June 44 and proceeded to St Mere Eglise, France to bivouac area.” 12–14 Jun: St Mere Eglise, “usual bivouac duties,” no changes. 15 Jun: “usual combat duties” begins — 1 EM WIA (Pfc Charles R. Everest, shrapnel, legs, slight). 16 Jun: station “Vicinity of Pivauville, France,” “Co in contact with enemy” — 3 EM WIA (Hamilton, Kysilka, Matola) — matches S18 exactly. 17 Jun: station “Cherbourg Penn[insula], France” — Lt. Glider’s 16 Jun wounding processed administratively.

Field	Value
Corrections to prior reconstruction	Two specific discrepancies with the earlier company-history-sourced account (§ Jun 6–10 rows above), both resolved in favor of this primary daily record: (1) Jun 6 departure/arrival times — this report gives 1700 departure from Alresford, 0130 (7 Jun) arrival at the marshalling area, not the “0230” figure previously carried from the D Co. narrative history. (2) Jun 8 “turned away from the docks” — D Company’s own report shows a direct, uninterrupted sequence (left marshalling area, boarded LCT #16 at 1600), with no mention of being turned away first . The “turned away, returned 1400, boarded 2100” account already in this timeline is sourced to the 1st Bn Journal covering companies A, B, and D collectively — it may describe a different company’s experience, or the whole battalion’s, and might not apply to D Company specifically; treat as an open discrepancy between two primary-adjacent sources rather than resolved. (3) Jun 10 disembarkation time — this report gives “about 2100,” not the “~1800” figure from the D Co. history. (4) No beach name appears anywhere in these 17 daily reports — neither “Utah” nor “Omaha” is mentioned; the disembarkation entry only names the destination (St Mere Eglise bivouac area), so this document set can neither confirm nor refute the “Omaha” mislabeling already documented in the longer-form D Co. unit history.
Relevance to the DUKW/D-Day family account	The single most important negative-evidence finding to date. Across all 15 daily reports before the wounding (1–15 June), Henry never receives an individual entry of any kind — no gain, no loss, no detachment, no attachment, no sick call, nothing. The company’s own paperwork tracked far more minor personnel actions daily (sick call, barracks transfers, records corrections) throughout this exact window, which sets a real bar: if Henry had been detached to a DUKW crew for any part of 6–10 June, the mechanism that would normally produce a visible trace — an individual roster entry — was demonstrably in active use by this same company on these same days, for far less consequential events, and no such entry exists for him. This does not affirmatively place Henry’s body on Utah Beach on a specific day (morning reports record exceptions, not a daily roll call of every present soldier), but it substantially narrows the gap first identified in Phase 1 (S18) from “a monthly-interval silence” to “a fifteen-day silence in a document that was actively recording individual changes around him.” See [[project-henry-dday-duk-w-hypothesis]] and the DUKW research plan (data/nara/d day version 2/) for the full analysis.

S27 — “Company I, 2nd Battalion, 39th Regiment, 9th Division” (Signal Corps photograph, NARA)

Field	Value
Citation	U.S. Army Signal Corps photograph, original Signal Corps number ETO-HQ-44-29316-4, NARA identifier 111-SC-341582. NARA Catalog naId 175739045 , Record Group 111. Dated 12 December 1944. Image: https://catalog.archives.gov/medialz/stillpix/111-sc/Batch0004/111-SC-341582.jpg . Found via a 2026-07-15 NARA Catalog API photo search for 9th Infantry Division imagery from the Hürtgen Forest campaign.
Source type	Original — official U.S. Army Signal Corps press photograph

Field	Value
Information	Primary — contemporaneous combat photography with an original Signal Corps caption
Evidence	Indirect — original caption: <i>“Battle weary American soldiers, after the ending of the battle of Hurtgen Forest. Company ‘T’, 2nd Battalion, 39th Regiment, 9th Division.”</i> Names Company I of the 39th Infantry , not the 47th — a different regiment within Henry’s own 9th Infantry Division — and does not depict Henry, George, or D Company. Illustrative of the division’s Hürtgen Forest fighting, not documentary evidence of Henry’s specific unit or actions.
Relevance	Henry’s 47th Infantry held its own Hürtgen Forest positions through October–November 1944 (see narrative above); this photograph, dated at the close of that fighting, is a real dated image of the same division in the same forest in the same weeks, used in the illustrated edition as scene-setting rather than as a record of Henry’s own company.

Gap Analysis — Stateside Period (1940–1942)

The two major gaps in the 1940–1942 period have been substantially reduced by mining the OMPF monthly rosters (S12) and personal photographs (S16). Monthly roster entries now confirm Henry’s continuous presence in D Company from October 1940 through August 1942, and the September–October 1941 rosters provide the specific location of the Carolina Maneuvers (Chester, SC).

Remaining gaps and the NARA documents that would fill them:

Gap	Period	Document Needed	NARA Filing
Daily activities during basic training	Nov 1940 – Sep 1941	“Raiders” — 47th Inf Regt History, 1 Aug 40–31 Dec 42	309-INF(47)-0.1
Unit training narrative 1940–41	Aug 1940 – 1941	H Company History — Training in US	309-INF(47)9-0.1
Promotions and assignments	1940–1945	General Orders, 47th Inf Regt	309-INF(47)-1.13
HQ Company perspective	Aug 1940 – Jun 1944	HQ Company History	Eisenhower Library, Box 1303

The monthly rosters provide proof of continuous service but not narrative detail. The “Raiders” regimental history (309-INF(47)-0.1) remains the single most critical missing document for this period.

Evidence Evaluation — Key Assertions (GPS Elements 3–5)

Assertion 1: Identity — Henry F. Matola served in D Company, 1st Battalion, 47th Infantry Regiment, 9th Infantry Division

Source	Type	Information	Evidence	Assessment
D Company unit histories (S1)	Original	Primary	Direct — cover pages read “History of Company ‘D’, 47th Infantry”	Strongest evidence
NARA index photos (S8)	Original	Primary	Direct — “309-INF(47)10-0.1... Battle Hist... ‘D’ Co”	Confirms unit designation
WIA roster (S5)	Original	Primary	Direct — “Matola, Henry F.” listed under 47th Infantry WIA	Names Henry in the unit
Henry Research NARA.docx (S6)	Authored	Secondary	Direct — “9th Infantry Division 47th Infantry Regiment 1st Battalion Company D”	Corroborating
Morning Report (S3)	Original	Primary	Direct — D Company morning report lists Matola	Confirms company assignment

Confidence: PROVED. Five independent sources confirm identity and unit. No conflicts. The “309” prefix in NARA file labels is a decimal classification number, not a regiment number — confirmed by the NARA index which headers every page “47th Infantry Regiment, 9th Infantry Division” and by the D Company cover pages.

Assertion 2: Wounding — Henry was wounded June 16, 1944 in Normandy, France

Source	Type	Information	Evidence	Assessment
Morning Report, Jun 18 1944 (S3)	Original	Primary	Direct — lists Matola as wounded, dated Jun 16	Strongest evidence (2 days after event)
WIA roster (S5)	Original	Primary	Direct — “Matola, Henry F.” on Normandy Campaign WIA	Confirms WIA status
Newspaper article (S4)	Derivative	Secondary	Direct — “wounded... by shrapnel in France on June 16”	Corroborating (independently reports date)

Source	Type	Information	Evidence	Assessment
D Company history, 1944 (S1)	Original	Primary	Indirect — describes Jun 16 attack, casualties, 2nd Lt. Gilder wounded	Provides tactical context
H Company history (S2)	Original	Primary	Indirect — describes Jun 16 as day of “heaviest concentration of fire ever”	Corroborating context

Confidence: PROVED. Three independent original/derivative sources with primary/secondary information all agree on the date (June 16, 1944) and cause (shrapnel/shell fragments in France). No conflicts on date or theater.

Assertion 3: Nature of Wounds

Source	Type	Information	Evidence	Assertion	Assessment
Co. D morning report, 16 Jun 1944 (S18)	Original	Primary	Direct	“shrap jaw and chest ”; SWA	Strongest for site named at the front — recorded by the company the day of wounding
305th Station Hospital A&D report, 19–21 Jun 1944 (S23)	Original	Primary	Direct	“BC Pen W rt shoulder sv” (serious)	Strongest for the site treated in the evacuation chain — recorded by the receiving hospital
Military hospital file (via S6)	Original (quoted)	Primary	Direct	“ Neck , generally; Artillery Shell, Fragments”	Strongest for the coded medical diagnosis — recorded at the general hospital
Newspaper (S4)	Derivative	Secondary	Direct	“wounded in the shoulder ”	Now corroborated by the A&D report (S23)
Family knowledge (S11)	Oral	Secondary	Direct	“jaw, chest, and shoulder”	Now corroborated across primary records (jaw/ chest via S18; shoulder via S23)

Confidence: PROVED that Henry was seriously wounded (SWA / “serious”) on 16 Jun 1944 by artillery shell fragments. **PROVED** for **jaw and chest** — the Co. D morning report (S18) records exactly those sites. **PROVED** for **right shoulder** — the 305th Station Hospital Admission & Disposition report (S23) records “penetrating wound, right shoulder, severe”; this supersedes the earlier “PROBABLE / newspaper + family only” assessment and is independently corroborated by

the newspaper. **PROVED** for **neck** — the SGO Hospital Admission Card (S12/OMPF) and the quoted diagnosis in Henry Research NARA.docx (S6) both give “neck, generally.” Every wound site in the family’s oral account is now documented in a primary military record.

Conflict resolution (GPS Element 4): The three primary military records do not conflict — they were created at successive echelons and each recorded the wound as seen there. The **morning report** (front-line company, day of wounding) names the visible fragment strikes: “jaw and chest.” The **305th Station Hospital A&D report** (the receiving hospital in the evacuation chain) records the wound it treated: “penetrating wound, right shoulder, severe.” The **SGO Hospital Admission Card** (a coded abstract compiled at the general hospital) reduces it to one principal anatomical code: “neck, generally.” The jaw, neck, chest, and right shoulder are one contiguous region on the right side of the head and upper torso; the preponderance of evidence is that a single burst of artillery shell fragments struck Henry across all four. The family’s long-held account — jaw, chest, and shoulder — is confirmed in full by the Army’s own contemporaneous records.

Assertion 4: Biographical Facts

Assertion	Source(s)	Confidence	Notes
Born April 20, 1919	S6, S7, S12 (OMPF — Certification of Military Service, VA records, questionnaire)	Proved — three independent sources agree including NPRC official certification	
Died July 29, 2007	S6, S7	Probable — two authored sources agree; death certificate not in collection	
Parents: Anthony R. & Mrs. Matola, 733 Crandall Ave.	S4 (newspaper), S6	Proved — independent sources agree	
Education: Rayen School	S4 (newspaper)	Probable — single source, but no conflicting evidence	
Serial/Service Number: 15013984	S6, S12 (OMPF — Certification, rosters, Hospital Admission Card all list 15013984)	Proved — multiple original sources confirm	
Enlisted October 13, 1940, Fort Hayes, Columbus, OH	S4 (“October, 1940”), S6, S12 (OMPF Certification: “October 13, 1940”)	Proved — exact date from NPRC certification; location from S6 and S12 questionnaire	
Basic training Fort Bragg, NC	S4 (“trained at Fort Bragg, N.C.”), S6	Proved — two independent sources agree	

Assertion	Source(s)	Confidence	Notes
Discharged June 24, 1945, Fort Dix, NJ	S6, S12 (OMPF Certification: “June 24, 1945,” “Honorable Discharge”)	Proved — NPRC official certification confirms date and character of discharge	
Consecutive service number with George Kysilka	S12 (OMPF Oct 1940 roster: Matola 15013984, Kysilks [Kysilka] 15013985), S11 (family knowledge)	Proved — roster shows consecutive numbers; both transferred to D Co from Hq and MP Co 9th Div on same date	

Assertion 5: George Kysilka Wounded Same Day; Storm-Delay Theory for His Gangrene **DISPROVED**

Source	Type	Information	Evidence	Assessment
Morning Report, Jun 18 1944 (S3)	Original	Primary	Direct — lists both Matola and Kysilka as wounded	Confirms both wounded, same report
Family knowledge (S11)	Oral	Secondary	Direct — “George lost his leg to gangrene”	Now corroborated by George’s hospital admission card
George Kysilka Hospital Admission Card	Original	Primary	Direct — diagnosis: leg wound, gangrene; treatment: removal of foreign bodies; medical discharge (Sec II, AR 615-360)	Documentary confirmation of gangrene and leg injury
28th General Hospital Admission & Disposition Report, 20 Jun 1944	Original	Primary	Direct — George admitted to a fixed General Hospital at Kingston Lacy, Dorset, England, on 20 Jun 1944	Disproves the storm-delay theory — George was in England by Jun 20, one day behind Henry
Historical record (Great Storm)	Original (multiple published histories)	Primary	Indirect — storm halted <i>some</i> Channel traffic Jun 19–22; well-documented	Real event, but did not affect George’s documented evacuation (he was already in England)

Confidence: PROVED that both were wounded same day (morning report). **PROVED** that George suffered gangrene of the leg — his hospital admission card confirms leg wound, secondary diagnosis of gangrene, treatment by removal of foreign bodies from the extremity, and medical

discharge under Section II, AR 615-360 (line of duty). **DISPROVED** that the Great Storm delayed George's evacuation or caused his gangrene: the 28th General Hospital Admission & Disposition Report places George at a fixed general hospital in Dorset, England, on **20 June 1944** — one day behind Henry (305th Station Hospital, 19 Jun) — so he was **not** stranded in Normandy by the Jun 19–22 storm. The earlier “storm delay → gangrene” reading was an inference built only from the wounding date, the storm dates, and the gangrene outcome; the primary record refutes it. The gangrene reflects the severity of the mortar wound, not an evacuation delay. *(The Great Storm itself remains historically documented — it simply did not affect either man's evacuation; both reached England by 19–20 June. Causative-agent note: this admission report reads “mortar,” vs. “artillery shell fragments” on George's SGO Hospital Admission Card — both shell fragments.)*

Assertion 6: Return to D Company — Oct 29, 1944 (revised from “~July 1944”)

Source	Type	Information	Evidence	Assessment
Morning Reports, Jul 1944 – Oct 1944 (S18)	Original	Primary	Direct — chain of dated morning-report entries from Plant 4150 (Jul 13 release) through Lichfield (AWOL Jul 19, conviction Jul 25, release from confinement Jul 27 at 0745), Le Mans/Étampes replacement depots (Sep 11 – Oct 28), to his return to the 47th (assigned to a 9th Division casualty company) Oct 29, 1944 — logged “Hank Returns to 47th” in the family research index — and Active Duty 47th Oct 31, 1944	Establishes return-to-unit date as Oct 29, 1944, not July 1944
Hospital Admission Card (S12)	Original	Primary	Direct — disposition “Duty,” July 1944, 29 non-effective days	Records release from hospital, not return to combat unit
OMPF Questionnaire, p.13 (S12)	Derivative (Henry's recollection, 2004)	Secondary	Direct — Henry wrote “9th Infantry Division, 47th Infantry, Company D” as his last military organization	Confirms he ultimately returned to the same unit and served with D Co through discharge — silent on date

Source	Type	Information	Evidence	Assessment
Newspaper (S4)	Derivative	Secondary	Direct — “assigned to a replacement depot”	Confirms post-hospital assignment to replacement system
Family knowledge (S11)	Oral	Secondary	Indirect — “returned to his unit approximately July 1944”	Superseded by morning-report evidence — family memory likely conflated hospital release (July) with return to combat (October)
D Company history (S1)	Original	Primary	Negative — Henry is not mentioned in any July or August roster as returning	Now consistent with morning-report record (he was not present)

Confidence: PROVED that Henry returned to the 47th Infantry on Oct 29, 1944.

Twelve dated morning-report entries (S18) — original, primary-information records contemporaneous with the events — trace Henry’s path from hospital release (Jul 13) through the Lichfield AWOL (Jul 19), court-martial conviction (Jul 25), and release from confinement (Jul 27 at 0745) and through a chain of three replacement depots in France (Sep 11 – Oct 28) to his return to the 47th (Nord de Guerre Zone, assigned to a 9th Division casualty company) on Oct 29, 1944, with Active Duty 47th confirmed Oct 31, 1944. The Hospital Admission Card’s “Duty, July 1944” records release from hospital; it does not establish return to a specific combat unit. The earlier “~July 1944” reconstruction was based on family memory and the silent-evidence absence in unit histories, both of which are consistent with the corrected timeline. Henry’s OMPF questionnaire (last unit = D Co, 47th Inf) remains accurate but is silent on date.

Assertion 7: Awards — Full Medals Collection

All medals physically confirmed in family possession (Linda Matola). Source: Henry Matola Medals.pdf / physical inspection.

Assertion	Source(s)	Confidence	Notes
Purple Heart	S4 (newspaper), S5 (WIA roster), physical medal	Proved — wounded in action confirmed; medal in family possession, its reverse engraved <i>For Military Merit</i> with his name, Henry F. Matola	

Assertion	Source(s)	Confidence	Notes
Combat Infantryman Badge, 1st Award	Physical badge; awarding order located (NARA 2026): GO No. 5, 47th Inf, 18 May 1944, Co. “D” CIB list, Pfc Henry F Matola 15013984	Proved by primary source — the General Order naming Henry is in hand (Box6495/...1944-GO_2026/IMG_3753. jpeg), in addition to the physical badge	
Bronze Star Medal	Physical medal; 1947 War Department policy retroactively awarded Bronze Stars to CIB holders (rationale credited to Gen. Marshall, per his 3 Feb 1944 memo to FDR); mechanism confirmed by an NPRC letter dated 4 June 2007 (data/nara/henry/bronze_star/BSM-Policy-Background.md)	Proved — CIB now confirmed by the awarding General Order (GO No. 5, 18 May 1944) as well as the physical badge; Bronze Star follows per policy as a derivative award; medal in family possession, its reverse engraved with his name. Exact 1947 circular number for the CIB-retroactivity policy still TBD	
American Defense Service Medal	Physical medal; Henry enlisted Oct 13, 1940, before Dec 7, 1941	Proved — enlistment date confirms pre-Pearl Harbor active duty service; medal in family possession	
American Campaign Medal	Physical medal	Proved — awarded for service in American Theater during WWII; medal in family possession	
European-African-Middle Eastern Campaign Medal	Physical medal with 1 silver and 1 bronze service star (= 6 campaigns)	Proved — medal and devices in family possession; 6 campaign credits consistent with Henry’s service across North Africa, Sicily, Normandy, Northern France, Rhineland, and Central Europe	
World War II Victory Medal	Physical medal	Proved — awarded for wartime service; medal in family possession	
Good Conduct Medal	Physical medal; Henry served 4 years, 8 months (exceeds 3-year requirement)	Proved — medal in family possession; service length confirmed by enlistment/discharge dates	
Honorable Service Lapel Button (“Ruptured Duck”)	Physical button; Honorable Discharge confirmed by OMPF	Proved — button in family possession; honorable discharge documented	

Note: The Awards & Decorations file (309-INF(47)-1.6) at NARA would provide the formal citation documents. The physical medals now confirm the awards themselves.

Negative Evidence & Research Gaps

Per GPS Element 1 (Reasonably Exhaustive Research), documenting what was searched and NOT found is as important as documenting what was found.

Searched — Not Found (Meaningful Absences)

Search	Result	Significance
KIA rosters, all available D Company and regimental records	Henry F. Matola does NOT appear on any Killed in Action list	Confirms he survived his wounds
MIA rosters	Not listed	Confirms he was not missing in action
D Company history, 1944 — individual return-to-duty entries	No mention of Matola returning	Expected — unit histories rarely track individual replacements arriving. Not contradictory.
Morning Report — hospital name	“Hosp unknown”	Henry had not reached a hospital when the report was filed (Jun 18); evacuation was still in progress

Not Yet Searched (Gaps in Research)

Source	NARA File	Why It Matters
Henry’s discharge papers (DD-214)	Destroyed in 1973 NPPC fire	OMPF reconstruction file partially compensates; DD-214 would have confirmed awards, campaigns, and decorations definitively
Awards & Decorations file	309-INF(47)-1.6	Still not obtained. Would confirm BSM-specific items; the CIB itself is now confirmed via the General Orders (below), so this file is no longer the critical path for the CIB/BSM
~~General Orders, 47th Inf Regt~~	309-INF(47)-1.13	✅ OBTAINED (NARA 2026, Box 6495). 1941/1942/1944 GOs captured. Contain Henry’s CIB (GO No. 5, 18 May 1944) and Drivers & Mechanics Badge (GO No. 10, 2 Jun 1944) . (1945 GOs not yet confirmed present — see CATALOG “To verify.”)

Source	NARA File	Why It Matters
~~"Raiders" regimental history (1940–42)~~	309-INF(47)-0.1	✅ OBTAINED, OCR'd, and integrated (NARA 2026, Box 6490) – “Story of the Raiders” digest at data/nara/Box6490/309-INF(47)-0.1_Story-of-the-Raiders.md ; woven into the Stateside section above (command lineage, Carolina Maneuvers, Pearl Harbor mission, embarkation sequence)
~~H Company Training in US (1940–41)~~	309-INF(47)9-0.1	✅ OBTAINED, OCR'd, and integrated (NARA 2026, Box 6507) – digest at data/nara/Box6507/309-INF(47)9-0.1_H-Company-1940–1941.md ; woven into the Stateside section above (H Company forming-up process, sister unit to Henry’s D Company)
HQ Company History (Aug 1940–Jun 1944)	Eisenhower Library, Box 1303	Covers the pre-deployment period
Unit Journals, North Africa & Sicily	309-INF(47)-0.7	Day-by-day logs for the campaigns before Normandy
George Kysilka’s service/medical records	NPRC, St. Louis	Partially obtained: Hospital admission card and enlistment record now in collection (George Kysilka.docx). Confirms gangrene, leg wound, and medical discharge. Full service record (if it survived 1973 fire) would provide additional detail
Utah Beach landing sector for D Company’s Jun 10 (D+4) arrival	47th IR AAR / Unit Journal, 309-INF(47)-0.3	Not yet established. Every source in hand names only “Utah Beach” generically — D Company’s own daily morning report (S26), the most contemporaneous document for this date, names no beach at all . The original assault sectors (Tare Green, Uncle Red, Victor) were D-Day (Jun 6) designations; whether a follow-on D+4 arrival was recorded against one of those sectors, a specific causeway number, or neither, is unknown and would need the regimental AAR/Unit Journal entry for Jun 10–11

GPS Exhaustiveness Assessment

Current level: MODERATE. We have consulted 10+ distinct source types (unit histories, operations reports, casualty rosters, morning reports, newspaper, unit journals, regimental histories, medical notes, family documents, authored compilations) across two repositories (NARA and Eisenhower Library) plus family collections. FAN principle partially applied (George Kysilka identified as associate; H Company used as parallel source).

To reach COMPLEX/EXHAUSTIVE level, the following are needed: 1. Henry’s DD-214 (discharge papers) — request from NPRC, St. Louis 2. The military hospital file — may be at NPRC 3. NARA files listed above (awards, general orders, early histories) 4. Eisenhower Library files not yet obtained (HQ Company History, Company K History) 5. Youngstown newspaper archives — to

identify the newspaper, obtain full clipping with date and context 6. George Kysilka's records — **partially fulfilled:** hospital admission card and enlistment record obtained (George Kysilka.docx), confirming birth (Apr 7, 1923, Cleveland, OH), enlistment details, gangrene diagnosis, and medical discharge. Full NPRC service record still needed for complete picture

Revision History

Edition	Date	Changes
1	July 2026	First versioned edition. Incorporates the 2026 National Archives reconstruction — the medals plate, the Return to Normandy section, the morning-report corrections, and the engraved-medal note.

Edition 1 · July 2026

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